

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Parliament - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Parliament REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01 ARTICLE 79 ARCHITECTURE: WHAT PARLIAMENT CONSTITUTIONALLY IS Article 79 constitutes Parliament as the President, Council of States	02 COMPOSITION, ELECTION, TERM AND SEAT CEILINGS Articles 80, 81 and 83 regulate House composition, representation,
03 REPRESENTATION, DELIMITATION AND THE SEAT-FREEZE BARGAIN Articles 81 and 82 operate with the 42nd, 84th and 87th Amendments	04 QUALIFICATIONS, DISQUALIFICATIONS AND VACANCIES Articles 84, 101, 102 and 103 separate qualification, vacancy and
05 LEADER OF OPPOSITION AND OPPOSITION ARCHITECTURE The 1977 Act defines the Leader of Opposition through recognition	06 SESSIONS, SITTINGS, ADJOURNMENT, PROROGATION AND DISSOLUTION Articles 83 and 85 distinguish duration, summoning, prorogation and
07 QUESTIONS, ZERO HOUR, DISCUSSIONS AND MOTIONS House rules and Article 75(3) connect information devices with the	08 PRESIDING OFFICERS: AUTHORITY, CONTINUITY AND NEUTRALITY Articles 89 to 97 govern election, tenure, removal, continuity and
09 PARLIAMENTARY PRIVILEGES AND THE SITA SOREN BOUNDARY Article 105 protects speech, votes and authorised publication subject	10 LEGISLATIVE PROCEDURE FOR AN ORDINARY BILL Articles 107 and 111 structure introduction, bicameral passage, return
11 ORDINARY, MONEY, FINANCIAL AND CONSTITUTION AMENDMENT BILLS Articles 109, 110, 117 and 368 create distinct procedures for fiscal and	12 JOINT SITTING, LEGISLATIVE DEADLOCK AND BILL LAPSE Article 108 supplies joint sitting for eligible deadlocks while
13 BUDGET, GRANTS AND THE CONSTITUTIONAL FUNDS Articles 112 to 116 and 266 to 267 regulate grants, appropriation and	14 PARLIAMENTARY CONTROL OF THE EXECUTIVE Article 75(3) anchors collective responsibility within a wider
15 PARLIAMENTARY COMMITTEES: ARCHITECTURE AND EXACT CONTROLS Financial committees, DRSCs and ad hoc bodies divide audit,	16 RAJYA SABHA: EQUAL, UNEQUAL AND EXCLUSIVE POWERS Articles 109, 249, 312 and 368 create a graded rather than uniformly
17 ANTI-DEFECTION, WHIP AND THE INDIVIDUAL PARLIAMENTARIAN The Tenth Schedule regulates party exit and whip defiance, with	18 INDIAN PARLIAMENTARY GROUP, IPU AND CPA IPG is Indian National Group in the IPU and main India Branch of the
19 PARLIAMENTARY DECLINE: DIAGNOSIS, COUNTER-EVIDENCE AND REFORM Executive agenda control, wide whip, disruption, guideline and	20 LIVE UNIT: 106TH AMENDMENT, CENSUS 2027 AND DELIMITATION Article 154A requires published post-commencement census figures

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Polity 17 - Parliament - Complete Topic Package	7
Package method, source priority and current control	7
Roadmap	7
Scope ownership and cross-links	8
BASIC LEARNING SESSION	8
SESSION 1 - ARTICLE 79 ARCHITECTURE: WHAT PARLIAMENT CONSTITUTIONALLY IS	9
SESSION 2 - COMPOSITION, ELECTION, TERM AND SEAT CEILINGS	10
SESSION 3 - REPRESENTATION, DELIMITATION AND THE SEAT-FREEZE BARGAIN	11
SESSION 4 - QUALIFICATIONS, DISQUALIFICATIONS AND VACANCIES	13
SESSION 5 - LEADER OF OPPOSITION AND OPPOSITION ARCHITECTURE	15
SESSION 6 - SESSIONS, SITTINGS, ADJOURNMENT, PROROGATION AND DISSOLUTION	16
SESSION 7 - QUESTIONS, ZERO HOUR, DISCUSSIONS AND MOTIONS	17
SESSION 8 - PRESIDING OFFICERS: AUTHORITY, CONTINUITY AND NEUTRALITY	19
SESSION 9 - PARLIAMENTARY PRIVILEGES AND THE SITA SOREN BOUNDARY	21
SESSION 10 - LEGISLATIVE PROCEDURE FOR AN ORDINARY BILL	22
SESSION 11 - ORDINARY, MONEY, FINANCIAL AND CONSTITUTION AMENDMENT BILLS	23
SESSION 12 - JOINT SITTING, LEGISLATIVE DEADLOCK AND BILL LAPSE	25
SESSION 13 - BUDGET, GRANTS AND THE CONSTITUTIONAL FUNDS	26
SESSION 14 - PARLIAMENTARY CONTROL OF THE EXECUTIVE	28
SESSION 15 - PARLIAMENTARY COMMITTEES: ARCHITECTURE AND EXACT CONTROLS	29
SESSION 16 - RAJYA SABHA: EQUAL, UNEQUAL AND EXCLUSIVE POWERS	31
SESSION 17 - ANTI-DEFECTION, WHIP AND THE INDIVIDUAL PARLIAMENTARIAN	33
SESSION 18 - INDIAN PARLIAMENTARY GROUP, IPU AND CPA	34
SESSION 19 - PARLIAMENTARY DECLINE: DIAGNOSIS, COUNTER-EVIDENCE AND REFORM	35
SESSION 20 - LIVE UNIT: 106TH AMENDMENT, CENSUS 2027 AND DELIMITATION	37
BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION	39
Original MCQ loop - strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation	39
OM1. Constitutional composition	39
OM2. Rajya Sabha election	40

OM3. Seat-freeze extension	40
OM4. Lok Sabha nomination	40
OM5. Article 84	40
OM6. Sitting-member disqualification	40
OM7. Leader of Opposition	40
OM8. Prorogation	41
OM9. Starred question	41
OM10. No-confidence motion	41
OM11. Speaker after dissolution	41
OM12. Speaker's removal resolution	41
OM13. Sita Soren	41
OM14. Ordinary Bill deadlock	41
OM15. Money Bill	42
OM16. Financial Bill-II	42
OM17. Joint-sitting history	42
OM18. Bill lapse	42
OM19. Charged expenditure	42
OM20. Token cut	42
OM21. Public Account	42
OM22. PAC	43
OM23. Estimates Committee	43
OM24. DRSC composition	43
OM25. Welfare of SCs/STs Committee	43
OM26. Rajya Sabha's exclusive powers	43
OM27. Anti-defection merger	43
OM28. Nominated member under Tenth Schedule	43
OM29. IPG	44
OM30. 106th Amendment status	44
OM31. Census trigger	44
OM32. 2026 delimitation package	44
OM33. Money Bill judicial status	44
OM34. Deputy Speaker	44

OM35. Parliamentary reform	45
OM36. MPLADS	45
Remedial MCQs - strict A -> B -> A -> D rotation	45
RM1. President and membership	45
RM2. Session rule	45
RM3. Prorogation trap	45
RM4. Speaker removal	45
RM5. Financial Bill-I trap	46
RM6. Joint-sitting exclusion	46
RM7. Committee-number trap	46
RM8. Privilege trap	46
RM9. Rajya Sabha status	46
RM10. Women's reservation trap	46
RM11. 2026 Bill arithmetic	46
RM12. Deputy Speaker status	47
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	47
Answer-writing architecture	47
Directive fidelity	47
Mark-scaled evidence load	47
Reusable answer spines	48
Solved directly routed Mains PYQs	48
PYQ-M1. 2018 GS-II Q4 - Usefulness of parliamentary committees, especially the Estimates Committee	48
PYQ-M2. 2019 GS-II Q15 - Decline of the individual parliamentarian and debate quality	49
PYQ-M3. 2020 GS-II Q5 - "Once a Speaker, always a Speaker" and objectivity	49
PYQ-M4. 2020 GS-II Q14 - Rajya Sabha as a supporting organ	50
PYQ-M5. 2021 GS-II Q4 - Extent of Parliament's executive accountability	50
PYQ-M6. 2021 GS-II Q15 - Working of DRSCs in enforcing executive control	51
PYQ-M7. 2023 GS-II Q16 - Committee structure and role of financial committees	52
PYQ-M8. 2024 GS-II Q3 - Cabinet growth and marginalisation of parliamentary supremacy	52
Routed Parliament Prelims demand laboratory	53
2018-2023 routed demands: 11	53
2024-2025 routed demands: 7	54

2026 routed demands: 2	54
Original solved Mains practice	55
M1. Explain how the constitutional design of parliamentary sessions both enables and limits executive accountability. (10 marks, 150 words)	55
M2. Legislative privilege is a functional immunity, not a personal impunity. Discuss with reference to Sita Soren. (10 marks, 150 words)	55
M3. The Money Bill procedure is necessary for popular control of finance but vulnerable to bicameral bypass. Critically examine. (15 marks, 250 words)	56
M4. Parliament's power of the purse is exercised through a chain, not a single budget vote. Analyse. (15 marks, 250 words)	56
M5. Delimitation after the population freeze is simultaneously a democratic-equality and a federal-fairness problem. Examine with reference to the women's reservation trigger. (15 marks, 250 words)	57
M6. "Parliament is strong in constitutional instruments but weak in their political use." Critically examine and propose reforms. (20 marks, 250 words)	57
M7. Evaluate whether Rajya Sabha and parliamentary committees together can compensate for executive dominance of Lok Sabha. (20 marks, 250 words)	58
OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER	58
A1. Constitutional supremacy versus parliamentary supremacy	59
A2. Money Bill certification and the unresolved larger-Bench issue	59
A3. Procedure refinements that separate strong answers	59
A4. Committees as the realistic deliberative centre	60
A5. Concise source and current-control note	60
CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES	60
Article 79 identity card	60
Two Houses: composition, election and term	60
Delimitation and freeze chronology	61
Membership and disqualification quick card	61
Office of profit and Leader of Opposition	61
Session and sitting vocabulary	61
Questions and motions memory grid	62
Presiding-officer card	62
Privilege and bribery firewall	62
Bill procedure compact spine	62
Bill-class firewall	62
Money Bill current doctrine	63
Joint sitting and lapse rules	63

Budget and grant chain	63
Constitutional funds	63
Executive accountability stack	63
Committee numbers that must not be swapped	64
Rajya Sabha graded-power card	64
Anti-defection impact	64
IPG-IPU-CPA recall	64
Parliamentary decline and reform spine	65
Women's reservation three-register card	65
Census 2027 trigger card	65
Defeated 2026 Bills card	66
PYQ routing map	66
Universal Mains answer checklist	66
Final rapid-fire traps	66
COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM	67

Polity 17 - Parliament - Complete Topic Package

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** 17 | **GS-II + Prelims** | **Export date:** 2026-08-28 **Approval:** false - awaiting explicit user approval. **Evidence key:** [FACT] constitutional, judicial or officially verified proposition; [ANALYSIS] reasoned exam synthesis; [CURRENT] dated live control; [LIMIT] qualification preventing overstatement.

Package method, source priority and current control

- Source order followed: authoritative Core owner Polity/basic/Parliament.md -> optional procedural depth in Polity/advanced/17_Parliament.md -> cross-links in Polity 11, Polity 16, basic/Anti-Defection-Law.md, basic/Election-Commission.md, basic/Amendment-and-Basic-Structure.md and basic/President-and-Vice-President.md -> dated official controls. Qdrant was not used.
- [LIMIT] Foundation/Core below is independently answer-complete. Optional Advanced adds deeper doctrine and answer refinement; no examination answer depends on opening it.
- [CURRENT] Status is controlled to **28 August 2026, Asia/Kolkata**.
- [CURRENT] **Digital Sansad** is the official control for debates, Bills and committee activity. Its Lok Sabha debate record shows that the **8th Session of the 18th Lok Sabha was adjourned sine die on 13 August 2026**. No unsupported productivity percentage, sitting total or Bill count is used here.
- [CURRENT] The official PIB overview of the **7th Session** is available at <https://static.pib.gov.in/WriteReadData/specificdocs/documents/2026/apr/doc2026418851201.pdf>. It is retained as an official session source, not converted here into unverified statistics.
- [CURRENT] The **Constitution (One Hundred and Sixth Amendment) Act, 2023 commenced on 16 April 2026**, but the women's reservation is **not operational**. This package preserves the exact enacted -> commenced -> operational distinction.
- [CURRENT] Census 2027 conduct and reference dates are notified, but the date on which the relevant figures will be **published**, the date of delimitation and the date on which reservation will operate are all unknown.
- [CURRENT] The Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, Delimitation Bill and Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026 were introduced on 16 April 2026. The constitutional amendment was defeated on 17 April 2026 despite a 298:230 division among 528 members present and voting. They are treated only as **defeated Bills**, never as law, precedent or forecast.
- [CURRENT] No visible final decision on the larger-Bench Article 110 issue referred in *Rojer Mathew* was located on the official Supreme Court judgment portals as of 28 August 2026. The status is therefore stated narrowly and qualified.
- Package standard delivered: more than 20 text-native visuals, eight solved Mains PYQs, all 20 routed Prelims demands, 36 original MCQs, 12 remedial MCQs and seven original solved Mains questions.

Roadmap

Stage	Coverage	Exam outcome
Architecture	Article 79, bicameral design and constitutional supremacy	Defines Parliament correctly
Houses	Composition, election, terms and seat ceilings	Solves repeated Prelims traps
Representation	Delimitation, freeze, Census 2027 and 2026 Bills	Handles the live federal issue
Membership	Qualifications, disqualifications, office of profit and LoP	Connects Articles 84, 102 and 103
Time and devices	Sessions, quorum, questions, motions and notices	Explains daily accountability
Chairs and privilege	Speaker, Deputy Speaker, Chairman and <i>Sita Soren</i>	Answers institutional-neutrality demands

Stage	Coverage	Exam outcome
Law-making	Bill classes, stages, joint sitting and lapse	Builds complete legislative procedure
Public finance	Budget, grants, Bills and constitutional funds	Explains the power of the purse
Oversight	Questions, motions, audit and committees	Evaluates executive accountability
Bicameralism	Rajya Sabha equality, inequality and Articles 249/312	Produces a graded second-chamber verdict
Political incentives	Anti-defection, executive dominance and decline	Moves from text to institutional analysis
Reform and diplomacy	Reforms, IPG, IPU and CPA	Adds conclusion-ready value
Practice	PYQs, MCQs, remedials and Mains models	Converts knowledge into marks

Scope ownership and cross-links

- **Polity 11 - Parliamentary System:** fusion of powers, collective responsibility, parliamentary versus presidential government and cabinet dominance.
- **Polity 16 - PM and Council of Ministers:** Article 75(3), executive coordination, cabinet control of the agenda and the 2024 GS-II cabinet-growth route.
- **Anti-Defection Law:** Tenth Schedule grounds, Speaker as tribunal, judicial review and whip reform.
- **Election Commission:** Article 103 decisions, RPA disqualifications and election-petition routes.
- **Amendment and Basic Structure:** Article 368 procedure, State ratification and the absence of joint sitting.
- **President and Vice-President:** summoning, prorogation, dissolution, assent, ordinance and the Rajya Sabha Chair.
- [LIMIT] Cross-links prevent duplication, but every Parliament-specific rule required for Prelims and GS-II is complete in Part I.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - ARTICLE 79 ARCHITECTURE: WHAT PARLIAMENT CONSTITUTIONALLY IS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Parliament joins the President with two Houses in one constitutional legislature.

Technical definition: Article 79 constitutes Parliament as the President, Council of States and House of the People.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

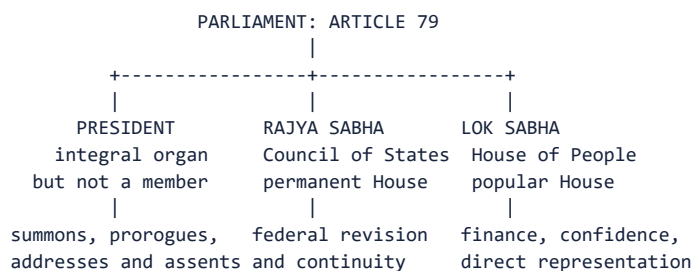
The central issue is parliament joins the President with two Houses in one constitutional legislature.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 79
- President
- Rajya Sabha
- Lok Sabha
- bicameral Parliament

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 79; define President, connect Rajya Sabha with Lok Sabha to explain the mechanism, and use bicameral Parliament for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 1 - Tripartite architecture



- [FACT] Article 79 creates Parliament as the **President + Council of States + House of the People**.
- [FACT] The President is not a member of either House but is indispensable to summoning, prorogation, address and assent.
- [ANALYSIS] Bicameralism divides democratic authority: Lok Sabha supplies direct popular legitimacy; Rajya Sabha supplies continuity, revision and a State-based federal voice.
- [LIMIT] India borrowed responsible parliamentary government, not British parliamentary sovereignty. A written Constitution, federal distribution, Fundamental Rights, judicial review and the basic-structure doctrine bind Parliament.

Core thesis: Indian Parliament is politically central but legally constituted and limited.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ARTICLE 79 ARCHITECTURE: WHAT PARLIAMENT CONSTITUTIONALLY IS

START / CONCEPT: Article 79 architecture: what Parliament constitutionally is

↓

EXACT TERMS: Article 79 · President · Rajya Sabha · Lok Sabha · bicameral Parliament

↓

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Presidential assent and two-House deliberation complete the Union legislative process.

↓

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This design combines popular authority, federal revision and constitutional form.

↓

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The President is part of Parliament but is not a member of either House.

↓

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The central issue is parliament joins the President with two Houses in one constitutional legislature.

SESSION 2 - COMPOSITION, ELECTION, TERM AND SEAT CEILINGS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The two Houses use different election methods, terms and membership structures.

Technical definition: Articles 80, 81 and 83 regulate House composition, representation, continuity and duration.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The central issue is the two Houses use different election methods, terms and membership structures.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- House composition
- Rajya Sabha election
- Lok Sabha election
- seat ceilings
- House terms

How to use them: Frame the answer through House composition; define Rajya Sabha election, connect Lok Sabha election with seat ceilings to explain the mechanism, and use House terms for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 2 - Two-House comparison matrix

Dimension	Rajya Sabha	Lok Sabha
Constitutional ceiling	[FACT] 250 : up to 238 elected + 12 nominated	[FACT] 550 : up to 530 States + 20 UTs
Stable sanctioned/elected figure	[FACT] 245 sanctioned ; working strength varies with vacancies	[FACT] 543 elected seats ; working strength varies with vacancies
Election	Indirect; elected State/eligible UT representatives through proportional representation by single transferable vote	Direct; territorial constituencies through first-past-the-post and universal adult suffrage
Nominated members	12 nominated by President for special knowledge/practical experience in literature, science, art and social service	None; Anglo-Indian nomination ceased after the 104th Amendment
Nature	Permanent; never dissolved	Normally five years; may be dissolved earlier
Individual term	Six years; roughly one-third retire every second year	House-wide term; members face dissolution together
Minimum age	30 years	25 years

Visual 3 - Election routes

RAJYA SABHA

State elected MLAs -> proportional representation -> STV -> elected RS member
|
+> open ballot under the RPA change of 2003

LOK SABHA

Eligible voters -> territorial constituency -> FPTP plurality -> elected MP

- [FACT] The 2003 removal of the Rajya Sabha candidate's State-domicile requirement and introduction of the open ballot came through amendment of the **Representation of the People Act, 1951**, not a constitutional amendment; *Kuldip Nayar v. Union of India* (2006) upheld it.
- [FACT] Lok Sabha's normal term under Article 83 is five years from its first meeting. During a national emergency Parliament may extend it by law for one year at a time, but not beyond six months after the emergency ends.
- [FACT] Rajya Sabha continuity means the whole Union legislature never disappears.
- [LIMIT] "Working strength" varies with vacancies. The stable exam facts are the ceilings, 245

sanctioned Rajya Sabha strength and 543 elected Lok Sabha seats.

Visual 4 - Continuity clock

Rajya Sabha: [1/3 retires]----2 years----[1/3 retires]----2 years----[1/3]
Member term: <----- 6 years ----->

Lok Sabha: first meeting ----- normally 5 years ----- dissolution
whole House is renewed; Speaker continues to new House's first sitting

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - COMPOSITION, ELECTION, TERM AND SEAT CEILINGS

START / CONCEPT: Composition, election, term and seat ceilings

|

v

EXACT TERMS: House composition · Rajya Sabha election · Lok Sabha election · seat ceilings · House terms

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Direct election renews Lok Sabha while staggered retirement preserves Rajya Sabha continuity.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Different mandates explain later differences in finance, confidence and federal revision.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Distinguish constitutional ceilings, sanctioned seats and vacancy-sensitive working strength.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The central issue is the two Houses use different election methods, terms and membership structures.

SESSION 3 - REPRESENTATION, DELIMITATION AND THE SEAT-FREEZE BARGAIN

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Delimitation balances population equality against fairness to low-growth States.

Technical definition: Articles 81 and 82 operate with the 42nd, 84th and 87th Amendments to control readjustment.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The central issue is delimitation balances population equality against fairness to low-growth States.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- delimitation
- seat freeze

- **Article 82**
- **population representation**
- **federal fairness**

How to use them: Frame the answer through delimitation; define seat freeze, connect Article 82 with population representation to explain the mechanism, and use federal fairness for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 5 - Constitutional timeline

1952	1962	1972	1976	2001	2003	after 2026
Delimitation Commission published Acts	Delimitation Commission Acts	Delimitation Commission Acts	42nd Amdt freezes allocation	84th Amdt extends freeze	87th Amdt boundaries on 2001 data	first census figures -> readjustment

2002 Delimitation Commission: fourth all-India commission

Jammu and Kashmir after 2019: distinct statutory exercise, not a fifth all-India cycle

- [FACT] Article 81(2)(a) seeks, so far as practicable, a similar population-to-seat ratio among States; Article 170 carries the parallel Assembly principle.
- [FACT] The **42nd Amendment (1976)** froze inter-State seat allocation on the 1971 Census basis; the **84th Amendment (2001)** extended readjustment until the relevant figures of the first census taken after 2026 are published; the **87th Amendment (2003)** permitted constituency-boundary readjustment on 2001 data without altering State seat totals.
- [ANALYSIS] The freeze rewarded population-control performance by preventing successful States from immediately losing relative political weight.
- [FACT] Article 82 links post-census readjustment to an authority Parliament determines; Delimitation Acts establish commissions. Article 329(a) insulates delimitation law and allotment from judicial challenge.
- [LIMIT] The freeze does not “expire automatically in 2026”. Publication of the relevant post-2026 census figures is the textual gate.
- [LIMIT] No post-freeze State-wise seat allocation, new House strength or women's-seat count exists in law.

Visual 6 - The federal dilemma

Population proportionality
+--> gives equal weight to equally sized populations
+--> may reduce relative power of low-growth States
+--> Rajya Sabha is also population-weighted, not equal-per-State like the US Senate
+--> possible federal bargaining shock

Balanced answer: democratic equality claim <-> demographic-performance fairness claim

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - REPRESENTATION, DELIMITATION AND THE SEAT-FREEZE BARGAIN

START / CONCEPT: Representation, delimitation and the seat-freeze bargain

↓

EXACT TERMS: delimitation · seat freeze · Article 82 · population representation · federal fairness

↓

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Published post-2026 census figures open the readjustment gate; they do not determine its outcome.

↓

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The process may improve vote equality while creating a new federal distribution bargain.

↓

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The freeze does not expire automatically in 2026, and projections are not law.

↓

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The central issue is delimitation balances population equality against fairness to low-growth States.

SESSION 4 - QUALIFICATIONS, DISQUALIFICATIONS AND VACANCIES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Qualifications, disqualifications and vacancies determine whether parliamentary membership begins, continues or ends.

Technical definition: Articles 84, 101, 102 and 103 separate qualification, vacancy and sitting-member disqualification.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Qualifications, disqualifications and vacancies form one membership-control sequence.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 84
- Article 102
- Article 103
- office of profit
- member vacancy

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 84; define Article 102, connect Article 103 with office of profit to explain the mechanism, and use member vacancy for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 7 - Membership gate

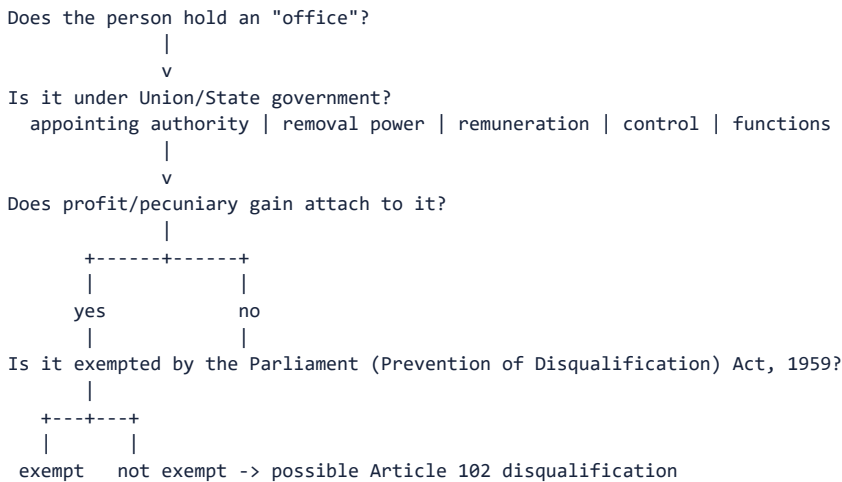
QUALIFY (Article 84)	REMAIN QUALIFIED (Article 102)
Citizen of India	no disqualifying office of profit
Oath/affirmation as prescribed	not declared of unsound mind by court
Age: 30 RS / 25 LS	not an undischarged insolvent
Other qualifications by Parliament	no foreign citizenship/allegiance
↓	no statutory disqualification
↓	no Tenth Schedule disqualification
valid candidature	↓
	Article 103: President decides, after obtaining ECI opinion

- [FACT] Article 84 supplies constitutional qualifications; Parliament adds statutory qualifications through election law.
- [FACT] Article 102(1) lists office of profit, court-declared unsoundness of mind, undischarged insolvency, loss/acquisition of citizenship or foreign allegiance and disqualification under parliamentary law. Article 102(2) adds Tenth Schedule defection.

- [FACT] RPA 1951 grounds include specified convictions, corrupt practices, dismissal for corruption/disloyalty, government contracts, office under a government company and failure to lodge election-expense accounts.
- [FACT] *Lily Thomas v. Union of India* (2013) removed the former sitting-member shield in RPA section 8(4); a qualifying conviction can cause immediate disqualification. A stay of the **conviction**, not merely the sentence, is the relevant relief.
- [FACT] For a question whether a sitting member has incurred an Article 102(1) disqualification, Article 103 places the decision with the President, who must obtain the ECI's opinion.
- [LIMIT] Election validity is challenged through an election petition in the High Court; it is not identical to the Article 103 sitting-member reference.

Office of profit

Visual 8 - Office-of-profit test



- [FACT] The office-of-profit rule protects legislative independence from executive patronage.
- [FACT] The **Parliament (Prevention of Disqualification) Act, 1959** exempts specified offices; exemption is statutory and office-specific.
- [ANALYSIS] Courts use substance rather than label: appointment/removal, remuneration, control and governmental character matter.
- [LIMIT] "Office of profit" is not synonymous with every public office or every paid activity.

Vacancy and double membership

- [FACT] Article 101 governs vacation of seats, including simultaneous membership questions and prolonged absence without House permission.
- [FACT] A member may resign in writing to the Speaker/Chairman; the presiding officer may refuse to accept if not satisfied that resignation is voluntary or genuine.
- [FACT] The House may declare a seat vacant after absence for sixty days without permission, excluding periods specified by Article 101.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - QUALIFICATIONS, DISQUALIFICATIONS AND VACANCIES

START / CONCEPT: Qualifications, disqualifications and vacancies

↓

EXACT TERMS: Article 84 · Article 102 · Article 103 · office of profit · member vacancy

↓

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The President decides Article 102(1) questions after obtaining the Election Commission opinion.

↓

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: These routes protect legislative integrity without merging election petitions and vacancy rules.

↓

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: A stay of sentence is not the same as a stay of conviction for disqualification.

↓

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Qualifications, disqualifications and vacancies form one membership-control sequence.

SESSION 5 - LEADER OF OPPOSITION AND OPPOSITION ARCHITECTURE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The recognised opposition leader is a statutory office, not merely the largest rival-party label.

Technical definition: The 1977 Act defines the Leader of Opposition through recognition by the presiding officer.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The central issue is the recognised opposition leader is a statutory office, not merely the largest rival-party label.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Leader of Opposition
- 1977 Act
- Speaker recognition
- opposition party
- ten percent practice

How to use them: Frame the answer through Leader of Opposition; define 1977 Act, connect Speaker recognition with opposition party to explain the mechanism, and use ten percent practice for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 9 - Opposition distinctions

Institution	Legal/procedural character	Exam caution
Leader of Opposition	[FACT] Statutory office under the Salary and Allowances of Leaders of Opposition in Parliament Act, 1977	The Act does not prescribe a ten-percent threshold; recognition is by the presiding officer
Largest opposition party leader	Political fact	May exist even where no person is formally recognised as LoP
Opposition party	Party outside government	Do not equate every opposition party with the "official opposition"
Committee chair from Opposition	Convention in specified context, notably PAC	Not a universal rule for all committees

- [FACT] The 1977 Act defines the LoP through recognition by the Speaker/Chairman and does not itself prescribe a numerical threshold. The one-tenth rule belongs to parliamentary recognition practice, not the statutory text. The 16th and 17th Lok Sabhas had no recognised LoP.

- [LIMIT] For the 2018 Prelims historical demand, do not invent or casually assert the identity of the “first Lok Sabha opposition party” unless the precise official source/question wording is before you.
- [ANALYSIS] A recognised LoP matters beyond debate: statutes often place the office on selection committees, making recognition part of institutional checks.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - LEADER OF OPPOSITION AND OPPOSITION ARCHITECTURE

START / CONCEPT: Leader of Opposition and opposition architecture

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Leader of Opposition • 1977 Act • Speaker recognition • opposition party • ten percent practice

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Recognition connects parliamentary opposition with statutory selection and accountability roles.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A recognised office strengthens institutional checks beyond ordinary floor criticism.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The 1977 Act itself prescribes no ten-percent threshold; do not confuse practice with text.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The central issue is the recognised opposition leader is a statutory office, not merely the largest rival-party label.

SESSION 6 - SESSIONS, SITTINGS, ADJOURNMENT, PROROGATION AND DISSOLUTION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Parliamentary time moves from House term to session to individual sitting.

Technical definition: Articles 83 and 85 distinguish duration, summoning, prorogation and Lok Sabha dissolution.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The central issue is parliamentary time moves from House term to session to individual sitting.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 85
- parliamentary session
- adjournment
- prorogation
- Lok Sabha dissolution

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 85; define parliamentary session, connect adjournment with prorogation to explain the mechanism, and use Lok Sabha dissolution for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 10 - Time hierarchy


```

HOUSE TERM
|
+-- SESSION (summoned and prorogued by President)
|
+-- SITTING (opened, adjourned or adjourned sine die by presiding officer)

```

Adjournment -> pauses a sitting
 Adjournment sine die -> ends a sitting without fixing the next date
 Prorogation -> ends the session; pending Bills survive, notices usually lapse
 Dissolution -> ends Lok Sabha itself; Rajya Sabha is never dissolved

- [FACT] Article 85 requires the President to summon each House so that six months do not intervene between the last sitting of one session and the first sitting of the next.
- [FACT] The rule guarantees at least two sessions in a year, not a constitutionally fixed “Budget-Monsoon-Winter” calendar and not a minimum number of sitting days.
- [FACT] Budget, Monsoon and Winter are conventional labels; they are not constitutional categories and should not be frozen as mandatory counts.
- [FACT] The President prorogues either House and dissolves the Lok Sabha; presiding officers adjourn sittings.
- [CURRENT] The 8th Session of the 18th Lok Sabha was adjourned sine die on **13 August 2026**. This is a dated event, not a rule about future session numbering or duration.

Visual 11 - Quorum and voting

Total House strength -> quorum = one-tenth under Article 100(3)

Lok Sabha: 550 ceiling -> Core recall figure 55
 Rajya Sabha: 250 ceiling -> Core recall figure 25

Members present and voting decide ordinary questions
 Presiding officer ordinarily does not vote -> casting vote only on a tie

- [FACT] If quorum is absent, the presiding officer must adjourn or suspend the meeting until quorum exists.
- [LIMIT] Vacancies do not invalidate House proceedings merely because seats are unfilled.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SESSIONS, SITTINGS, ADJOURNMENT, PROROGATION AND DISSOLUTION

```

START / CONCEPT: Sessions, sittings, adjournment, prorogation and dissolution
|
v
EXACT TERMS: Article 85 · parliamentary session · adjournment · prorogation · Lok Sabha dissolution
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The President summons and prorogues; presiding officers adjourn; dissolution
ends Lok Sabha life.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Correct time vocabulary determines whether business survives and
accountability can recur.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Budget, Monsoon and Winter are conventional labels, not constitutional
categories.
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The central issue is parliamentary time moves from House term to
session to individual sitting.

```

SESSION 7 - QUESTIONS, ZERO HOUR, DISCUSSIONS AND MOTIONS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Questions and motions convert parliamentary sitting time into public executive accountability.

Technical definition: House rules and Article 75(3) connect information devices with the Lok Sabha confidence sanction.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The central issue is questions and motions convert parliamentary sitting time into public executive accountability.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Question Hour
- Zero Hour
- no confidence
- parliamentary motions
- executive accountability

How to use them: Frame the answer through Question Hour; define Zero Hour, connect no confidence with parliamentary motions to explain the mechanism, and use executive accountability for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 12 - Question taxonomy

Device	Reply	Supplementaries	Core use
Starred question	Oral	Yes	Live ministerial cross-examination
Unstarred question	Written	No	Detailed factual disclosure
Short-notice question	Oral, on urgent matter with shorter notice	Yes	Urgent accountability
Supplementary	Follow-up to oral answer	It is itself the follow-up	Tests and clarifies the minister's reply

- [FACT] Question Hour is rule-based. Zero Hour is an Indian parliamentary innovation conventionally dated to 1962 and is not formally in the Rules.
- [ANALYSIS] Written questions build an administrative record; oral supplementaries expose omissions in real time.

Visual 13 - Accountability ladder

INFORMATION

Questions -> Zero Hour -> Calling Attention -> Half-an-Hour Discussion

DEBATE AND CRITICISM

Short-Duration Discussion -> Censure Motion -> Adjournment Motion

FINANCIAL PRESSURE

Cut Motions -> refusal of supply

SURVIVAL

No-Confidence Motion in Lok Sabha

Device	Purpose	Key distinction
Calling Attention	Urgent matter of public importance; ministerial statement	Indian innovation; does not itself test confidence
Half-an-Hour Discussion	Clarifies a matter arising from an answer	Information-focused
Short-Duration Discussion	Debate without a formal vote	Discussion, not censure
Adjournment Motion	Interrupts normal business for a definite urgent matter; censures government	Lok Sabha; requires support of 50 members
Censure Motion	Condemns specified policy/action	Reasons must be stated; may target a minister/group/council
No-Confidence Motion	Tests whether the Council retains Lok Sabha confidence	No reasons required; support of 50 members for admission
Motion of Thanks	Responds to President's Address	Amendments may politically test government

- [FACT] Article 75(3) makes the Council of Ministers collectively responsible to the **Lok Sabha**, so the confidence key lies only there.

- [LIMIT] Rajya Sabha may criticise, question and defeat ordinary legislation, but cannot constitutionally remove the Union ministry through no-confidence.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - QUESTIONS, ZERO HOUR, DISCUSSIONS AND MOTIONS

START / CONCEPT: Questions, Zero Hour, discussions and motions

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Question Hour · Zero Hour · no confidence · parliamentary motions · executive accountability

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Questions obtain information, motions escalate criticism, and no-confidence tests survival.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The devices span disclosure, debate, censure, financial pressure and government removal.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Zero Hour is conventional; an adjournment motion is not the same as no-confidence.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The central issue is questions and motions convert parliamentary sitting time into public executive accountability.

SESSION 8 - PRESIDING OFFICERS: AUTHORITY, CONTINUITY AND NEUTRALITY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Presiding officers combine procedural control with duties requiring visible impartiality.

Technical definition: Articles 89 to 97 govern election, tenure, removal, continuity and voting of parliamentary chairs.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The central issue is presiding officers combine procedural control with duties requiring visible impartiality.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Lok Sabha Speaker
- Deputy Speaker
- Rajya Sabha Chairman
- presiding officer neutrality
- Article 94

How to use them: Frame the answer through Lok Sabha Speaker; define Deputy Speaker, connect Rajya Sabha Chairman with presiding officer neutrality to explain the mechanism, and use Article 94 for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 14 - Lok Sabha chair hierarchy

HOUSE ELECTS UNDER ARTICLE 93

|

+-----+

|

SPEAKER DEPUTY SPEAKER

|

rules, order, substitutes when Speaker absent;
Money Bill, answerable to House, not subordinate
joint sitting,
casting vote,
Tenth Schedule

Speaker

- [FACT] Articles 93-97 govern the Speaker and Deputy Speaker. The House elects them from among its members.

- [FACT] The Speaker vacates by ceasing to be a member, resigning to the Deputy Speaker or removal by a majority of **all the then members of the House** after fourteen days' notice.
- [FACT] The Speaker does **not** vacate on dissolution; Article 94 continues the office until immediately before the first sitting of the new Lok Sabha.
- [FACT] During consideration of the Speaker's removal resolution, Article 96 prevents the Speaker from presiding. The Speaker may speak and vote in the first instance but has no casting vote in that proceeding.
- [FACT] Major powers include maintaining order, interpreting House rules, certifying a Money Bill, presiding over a joint sitting, using a casting vote on a tie and deciding Tenth Schedule petitions subject to judicial review.
- [ANALYSIS] These powers make impartiality structural, not ceremonial.

Deputy Speaker

- [FACT] The Deputy Speaker is independently elected by the House; when presiding, the Deputy Speaker exercises the Speaker's powers and is answerable to the House.
- [FACT] Article 93 says the House shall, as soon as may be, choose a Speaker and Deputy Speaker but fixes no numerical deadline.
- [CURRENT] The official Lok Sabha page checked on **28 August 2026** states that the position has been vacant since **May 2019**.
- [LIMIT] This is a dated current-office control, not a timeless constitutional rule.

Rajya Sabha Chairman and Deputy Chairman

- [FACT] Article 89 makes the Vice-President the ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha; the Chairman is not a Rajya Sabha member.
- [FACT] The House elects a Deputy Chairman from among its members.
- [FACT] The Chairman ordinarily has no first-instance vote and uses a casting vote on equality under Article 100.
- [FACT] When a resolution for removal of the Vice-President is under consideration, Article 92 prevents the Chairman from presiding.

Visual 15 - Neutrality problem

High decisional powers
 Money Bill + discipline + debate + defection
 |
 Party-linked route to office
 |
 Perception of partisan incentive
 |
 Reforms: convention of detachment | timely rulings |
 reasoned decisions | independent defection tribunal

- [ANALYSIS] Britain's "once a Speaker, always a Speaker" convention is not followed in India: the Speaker retains a party-linked political career and contests elections.
- [LIMIT] Institutional risk does not prove that every ruling is partisan. A good answer distinguishes design vulnerability from allegations in a particular case.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - PRESIDING OFFICERS: AUTHORITY, CONTINUITY AND NEUTRALITY

START / CONCEPT: Presiding officers: authority, continuity and neutrality

↓

EXACT TERMS: Lok Sabha Speaker · Deputy Speaker · Rajya Sabha Chairman · presiding officer
neutrality · Article 94

↓

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The chairs interpret rules, maintain order and exercise specified certification and tribunal powers.

↓

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Their decisions shape debate, membership, bicameralism and institutional legitimacy.

↓

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: official status checked in 2026 dates the Deputy Speaker vacancy from May 2019.

↓

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The central issue is presiding officers combine procedural control with duties requiring visible impartiality.

SESSION 9 - PARLIAMENTARY PRIVILEGES AND THE SITA SOREN BOUNDARY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Privilege protects legislative work but does not create personal immunity for bribery.

Technical definition: Article 105 protects speech, votes and authorised publication subject to constitutional limits.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The central issue is privilege protects legislative work but does not create personal immunity for bribery.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 105
- parliamentary privilege
- Sita Soren
- legislative bribery
- judicial review

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 105; define parliamentary privilege, connect Sita Soren with legislative bribery to explain the mechanism, and use judicial review for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 16 - Privilege shield

CORE PROTECTED ZONE	OUTSIDE THE SHIELD
Speech in House	bribery transaction
Vote in House	criminal act lacking functional nexus
Authorised parliamentary publication	mala fide exercise reviewable for illegality
Internal discipline and contempt powers	
+ -> protection exists so Parliament can function, not to create a personal criminal immunity	

- [FACT] Article 105 protects freedom of speech in Parliament subject to the Constitution and House rules, and immunises members from court proceedings for speech or vote in Parliament.
- [FACT] Privileges belong to each House, its members and committees; breach of privilege violates a specific privilege, while contempt is wider conduct that obstructs House functions.
- [FACT] Privilege powers are not wholly beyond judicial review. *Raja Ram Pal v. Speaker, Lok Sabha* (2007) accepted review for substantive or procedural illegality while respecting legislative autonomy.
- [FACT] In **Sita Soren v. Union of India (2024)** a unanimous seven-judge Bench overruled *P.V. Narasimha Rao* (1998): a legislator who accepts a bribe for a vote or speech receives **no Article 105/194 immunity**; the bribery offence is complete on acceptance.

- [LIMIT] *Sita Soren* removed a bribery shield. It did not abolish ordinary immunity for bona fide parliamentary speech and votes.

Visual 17 - Case logic

Was the act a speech/vote forming part of legislative functioning?

```

      |
      |----- yes ----- no -----
      |                     |
Article 105 immunity may attach  ordinary law applies
      |

```

Was there a separate bribe agreement/acceptance?

```

      |
      |----- yes -----> Sita Soren: no privilege immunity for bribery

```

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - PARLIAMENTARY PRIVILEGES AND THE SITA SOREN BOUNDARY

START / CONCEPT: Parliamentary privileges and the Sita Soren boundary

```

      |
      v
EXACT TERMS: Article 105 • parliamentary privilege • Sita Soren • legislative bribery • judicial
review
      |

```

```

      |
      v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The functional-nexus test protects genuine proceedings while leaving corrupt
bargains to criminal law.
      |

```

```

      |
      v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Sita Soren preserves institutional independence by denying immunity that
subverts it.
      |

```

```

      |
      v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Sita Soren (2024) removed bribery immunity, not ordinary speech-and-vote
protection.
      |

```

```

      |
      v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The central issue is privilege protects legislative work but does not
create personal immunity for bribery.

```

SESSION 10 - LEGISLATIVE PROCEDURE FOR AN ORDINARY BILL

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: An ordinary Bill becomes law only after both Houses agree and the President acts.

Technical definition: Articles 107 and 111 structure introduction, bicameral passage, return and presidential assent.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The central issue is an ordinary Bill becomes law only after both Houses agree and the President acts.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- ordinary Bill
- first reading
- second reading
- bicameral passage
- Article 111

How to use them: Frame the answer through ordinary Bill; define first reading, connect second reading with bicameral passage to explain the mechanism, and use Article 111 for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 18 - Five-stage route

FIRST READING
introduction and publication
|
SECOND READING
general discussion -> committee/reference -> clause-by-clause consideration
|
THIRD READING
final acceptance or rejection
|
SECOND HOUSE
pass | amend and return | reject | hold for six months
|
PRESIDENT: Article 111
assent | withhold | return once (if not a Money Bill)
|
If repassed: President cannot withhold assent

- [FACT] An ordinary Bill may originate in either House and may be introduced by a minister or private member.
- [FACT] Both Houses must agree to identical text.
- [FACT] The President may return a non-Money Bill once. If both Houses pass it again, with or without amendment, the President shall not withhold assent.
- [ANALYSIS] Committee reference is the point at which general policy becomes clause-level legal scrutiny.
- [LIMIT] Not every Bill is constitutionally required to go to a committee; making referral routine is a reform proposal.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - LEGISLATIVE PROCEDURE FOR AN ORDINARY BILL

START / CONCEPT: Legislative procedure for an ordinary Bill
|
v
EXACT TERMS: ordinary Bill · first reading · second reading · bicameral passage · Article 111
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Introduction leads to debate and clause scrutiny, identical passage, then assent or return.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The sequence converts policy into tested legal text while preserving a limited suspensive veto.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Committee referral is valuable but is not constitutionally automatic for every Bill.
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The central issue is an ordinary Bill becomes law only after both Houses agree and the President acts.

SESSION 11 - ORDINARY, MONEY, FINANCIAL AND CONSTITUTION AMENDMENT BILLS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Bill classification decides origin, recommendation, Rajya Sabha power and deadlock routes.

Technical definition: Articles 109, 110, 117 and 368 create distinct procedures for fiscal and amendment Bills.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The central issue is bill classification decides origin, recommendation, Rajya Sabha power and deadlock routes.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Money Bill
- Financial Bill
- Article 110
- Article 117

- Constitution Amendment Bill

How to use them: Frame the answer through Money Bill; define Financial Bill, connect Article 110 with Article 117 to explain the mechanism, and use Constitution Amendment Bill for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 19 - Bill classification tree

Does the Bill contain ONLY Article 110(1)(a)-(g) matters and incidental matters?

|
yes -> MONEY BILL

|
no
v

Does it contain an Article 110 matter plus other matters?

|
yes -> FINANCIAL BILL-I: Article 117(1)

|
no
v

Would it involve expenditure from the Consolidated Fund?

|
yes -> FINANCIAL BILL-II: Article 117(3)
|
no -> ORDINARY BILL

Does it amend the Constitution? -> ARTICLE 368 CONSTITUTION AMENDMENT BILL

Visual 20 - Procedure comparison matrix

Feature	Ordinary Bill	Money Bill	Financial Bill-I	Financial Bill-II	Constitution Amendment Bill
Provision	General	Arts 109-110	Art 117(1)	Art 117(3)	Art 368
Origin	Either House	Lok Sabha only	Lok Sabha only	Either House	Either House
President recommendation	Not generally required for introduction	Required	Required	Required before consideration, not necessarily introduction	Not required
Rajya Sabha power	Equal	Recommend only; 14 days	Equal/full	Equal/full	Equal; must pass separately
Joint sitting	Possible	No	Possible	Possible	No
Speaker certificate	No	Yes	No Money Bill certificate	No	No
President may return	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	No; must assent after due passage

Money Bill firewall

- [FACT] Article 110 is exhaustive: a Bill is a Money Bill only if it contains **only** listed fiscal matters and incidental matters.
- [FACT] Article 109 gives Rajya Sabha fourteen days to recommend changes. Lok Sabha may accept or reject any recommendation; non-return within fourteen days results in deemed passage in Lok Sabha form.
- [FACT] Article 110(3) says the Speaker's decision is final, and the certificate is endorsed under Article 110(4).
- [LIMIT] Textual finality does not create absolute constitutional immunity. Judicial review remains narrow and is addressed in Optional Advanced.

Constitution Amendment Bill

- [FACT] It may begin in either House, must be passed separately by each House and has no joint-sitting escape.
- [FACT] The ordinary Article 368 special majority has two concurrent limbs: majority of total membership **and** two-thirds of members present and voting.
- [FACT] Amendments touching specified federal provisions also need ratification by at least half of State legislatures.

- [FACT] After valid passage the President must assent.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ORDINARY, MONEY, FINANCIAL AND CONSTITUTION AMENDMENT BILLS

START / CONCEPT: Ordinary, Money, Financial and Constitution Amendment Bills

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Money Bill · Financial Bill · Article 110 · Article 117 · Constitution Amendment Bill

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Classify first, then apply the correct House powers, recommendation rule and assent path.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Accurate classification prevents fiscal primacy from becoming an unintended bicameral bypass.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Financial Bill-I gives Rajya Sabha full power and is not a Money Bill.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The central issue is bill classification decides origin, recommendation, Rajya Sabha power and deadlock routes.

SESSION 12 - JOINT SITTING, LEGISLATIVE DEADLOCK AND BILL LAPSE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Deadlock and dissolution affect Bills differently according to class and procedural stage.

Technical definition: Article 108 supplies joint sitting for eligible deadlocks while dissolution rules determine lapse.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The central issue is deadlock and dissolution affect Bills differently according to class and procedural stage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 108
- joint sitting
- legislative deadlock
- Bill lapse
- Lok Sabha dissolution

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 108; define joint sitting, connect legislative deadlock with Bill lapse to explain the mechanism, and use Lok Sabha dissolution for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 21 - Article 108 deadlock route

Ordinary/eligible Financial Bill

|

Second House rejects OR final disagreement OR holds > 6 months

|

President may notify intention to summon joint sitting

|

Speaker presides -> members present and voting decide

|

Numerical strength normally favours Lok Sabha

NO joint sitting: Money Bill | Constitution Amendment Bill

- [FACT] Only three joint sittings have occurred: Dowry Prohibition Bill (1961), Banking Service Commission (Repeal) Bill (1978) and Prevention of Terrorism Bill (2002).
- [LIMIT] Joint sitting is an available constitutional mechanism, not an automatic consequence of every disagreement.

Visual 22 - Lapse decision tree on Lok Sabha dissolution

Where is the Bill?

```
|
+-- pending in Lok Sabha -----> LAPSES
|
+-- passed by Lok Sabha, pending in Rajya Sabha -----> LAPSES
|
+-- pending in Rajya Sabha, not passed by Lok Sabha --> SURVIVES
|
+-- passed by both, awaiting President's assent -----> SURVIVES
|
+-- returned by President -----> SURVIVES
|
+-- joint sitting already notified -----> SURVIVES
```

- [ANALYSIS] Rajya Sabha permanence protects Bills that originate and remain pending there; dissolution cuts off business dependent on the expired Lok Sabha's will.
- [FACT] Prorogation does not cause Bills to lapse.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - JOINT SITTING, LEGISLATIVE DEADLOCK AND BILL LAPSE

START / CONCEPT: Joint sitting, legislative deadlock and Bill lapse

|
v

EXACT TERMS: Article 108 · joint sitting · legislative deadlock · Bill lapse · Lok Sabha dissolution

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Rejection, final disagreement or six-month delay may trigger notification for an eligible Bill.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The mechanism can resolve ordinary deadlock while preserving special procedures for money and amendment.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: money Bills and Constitution Amendment Bills have no joint-sitting route.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The central issue is deadlock and dissolution affect Bills differently according to class and procedural stage.

SESSION 13 - BUDGET, GRANTS AND THE CONSTITUTIONAL FUNDS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Financial control runs from disclosure and voting to appropriation, spending and audit.

Technical definition: Articles 112 to 116 and 266 to 267 regulate grants, appropriation and constitutional funds.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The central issue is financial control runs from disclosure and voting to appropriation, spending and audit.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Annual Financial Statement
- demands for grants
- Appropriation Bill
- Consolidated Fund
- Public Account

How to use them: Frame the answer through Annual Financial Statement; define demands for grants, connect Appropriation Bill with Consolidated Fund to explain the mechanism, and use Public Account for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 23 - Budget sequence

Annual Financial Statement: Article 112
 |
 General discussion
 |
 DRSC scrutiny of ministry demands
 |
 Lok Sabha votes Demands for Grants: Article 113
 | |
 cut motions guillotine at deadline
 |
 Appropriation Bill: Article 114 -> legal authority to withdraw
 |
 Finance Bill -> taxation proposals enacted
 |
 PAC-CAG post-expenditure audit closes the loop

- [FACT] The Constitution calls the budget the **Annual Financial Statement**.
- [FACT] Expenditure charged on the Consolidated Fund may be discussed but is not submitted to vote; other expenditure is voted through demands for grants.
- [FACT] Rajya Sabha may discuss the budget but only Lok Sabha votes demands for grants, on the President's recommendation.
- [FACT] **Policy Cut** reduces a demand to **Re 1**; Economy Cut specifies a reduction; **Token Cut** reduces it by **Rs 100** to ventilate a grievance.
- [FACT] The guillotine puts remaining undiscussed demands to vote at the scheduled deadline.
- [ANALYSIS] The budget demonstrates Lok Sabha primacy and also the accountability cost of limited House time.

Visual 24 - Grant toolkit

Device	Time and purpose	Trap
Vote on Account	Advance for ordinary expenditure pending full budget	Not a separate full budget
Vote of Credit	Unexpected demand of indefinite character, often emergency-like	Amount/details cannot be stated with ordinary precision
Exceptional Grant	Special purpose outside the current service	Distinct from routine annual service
Supplementary Grant	Authorised amount proves insufficient	In-year top-up
Additional Grant	Need arises for a new service not in budget	New service
Excess Grant	Spending exceeded authorisation	Post-facto; PAC examines before regularisation

Visual 25 - Three constitutional funds

CONSOLIDATED FUND: Article 266(1)
 revenues + loans + loan recoveries
 withdrawal requires appropriation by law

PUBLIC ACCOUNT: Article 266(2)
 provident funds and other money held in trust
 withdrawal does not require parliamentary appropriation

CONTINGENCY FUND: Article 267
 advance for unforeseen expenditure at President's disposal
 later recouped from Consolidated Fund through legislative authorisation

- [FACT] The Appropriation Bill authorises withdrawal from the Consolidated Fund; the Finance Bill gives effect to taxation proposals.
- [FACT] An Appropriation Bill is treated through the Money Bill procedure.
- [LIMIT] "Parliament controls every withdrawal in the same way" is wrong: Public Account transactions do not require appropriation.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - BUDGET, GRANTS AND THE CONSTITUTIONAL FUNDS

START / CONCEPT: Budget, grants and the constitutional funds

↓

EXACT TERMS: Annual Financial Statement · demands for grants · Appropriation Bill · Consolidated Fund · Public Account

↓

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Lok Sabha votes demands, appropriation authorises withdrawal, and CAG-PAC review follows spending.

↓

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The chain makes public finance answerable before and after expenditure.

↓

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Charged expenditure is discussed not voted, and Public Account needs no appropriation.

↓

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The central issue is financial control runs from disclosure and voting to appropriation, spending and audit.

SESSION 14 - PARLIAMENTARY CONTROL OF THE EXECUTIVE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Parliament controls the executive through information, law, finance, committees and confidence.

Technical definition: Article 75(3) anchors collective responsibility within a wider architecture of legislative oversight.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

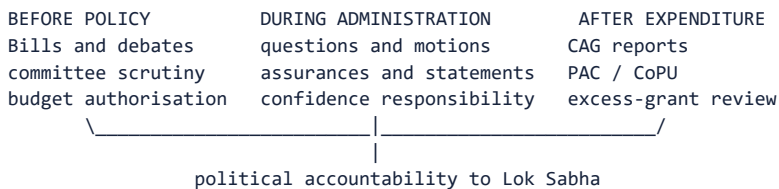
The central issue is parliament controls the executive through information, law, finance, committees and confidence.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Article 75(3)
- executive accountability
- financial control
- parliamentary committees
- no confidence

How to use them: Frame the answer through Article 75(3); define executive accountability, connect financial control with parliamentary committees to explain the mechanism, and use no confidence for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 26 - Control cycle



Control family	Instruments	What it can prove	Limitation
Informational	Questions, statements, Calling Attention	Disclosure and explanation	Answers may be incomplete; time is scarce
Deliberative	Debates, motions, President's Address	Public justification and criticism	Majority controls outcomes
Legislative	Amendment, rejection, committee scrutiny	Changes legal text	Government dominates most business
Financial	Demands, cuts, appropriation, PAC-CAG	Controls and audits public money	Guillotine and post-facto character

Control family	Instruments	What it can prove	Limitation
Responsibility	No-confidence and confidence	Tests authority to govern	Whip makes defeat unlikely for stable majority
Committee	DRSCs and specialised committees	Detailed, cross-party scrutiny	Reports are advisory and referral varies

- [FACT] Article 75(3) is the constitutional foundation of collective responsibility to Lok Sabha.
- [ANALYSIS] Parliament is **strong in instruments but weak in use** when party discipline, disruption and a compressed calendar prevent those instruments from operating.
- [ANALYSIS] Rajya Sabha contributes scrutiny even without the confidence key through questions, ordinary legislation, committees and federal debate.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - PARLIAMENTARY CONTROL OF THE EXECUTIVE

START / CONCEPT: Parliamentary control of the executive

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Article 75(3) • executive accountability • financial control • parliamentary committees • no confidence

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Questions disclose, Bills constrain, grants authorise, committees investigate and confidence decides survival.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Formal instruments become effective only when time, information and party incentives permit scrutiny.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Rajya Sabha scrutinises the executive but cannot remove the Union ministry.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The central issue is parliament controls the executive through information, law, finance, committees and confidence.

SESSION 15 - PARLIAMENTARY COMMITTEES: ARCHITECTURE AND EXACT CONTROLS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Committees provide specialised scrutiny that the full House often lacks time to perform.

Technical definition: Financial committees, DRSCs and ad hoc bodies divide audit, estimates, legislation and inquiry.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The central issue is committees provide specialised scrutiny that the full House often lacks time to perform.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Public Accounts Committee**
- **Estimates Committee**
- **DRSCs**
- **committee scrutiny**
- **ad hoc committee**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Public Accounts Committee; define Estimates Committee, connect DRSCs with committee scrutiny to explain the mechanism, and use ad hoc committee for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 27 - Committee hierarchy

PARLIAMENTARY COMMITTEES

```

|
+-- STANDING: continuing category, generally reconstituted periodically
|   |
|   +-- financial committees
|   +-- Department-related Standing Committees
|   +-- House/business committees
|   +-- inquiry/oversight committees
|
+-- AD HOC: end after assigned work
|   |
|   +-- Select/Joint Committees on Bills
|   +-- Joint Parliamentary Committees for a specified inquiry

```

Not a parliamentary committee:

Consultative Committee chaired by a minister

Financial committees

Visual 28 - Financial trio

Committee	Exact composition	Chair/control	Function	Membership caution
Public Accounts Committee	22 = 15 LS + 7 RS	Opposition chair by convention since 1967	CAG reports, appropriation and financial regularity	Ministers barred; ordinarily does not question policy itself
Estimates Committee	30, Lok Sabha only	Ruling-party chair	Economy, efficiency and alternative policy/administrative arrangements in estimates	No Rajya Sabha members; ministers barred
Committee on Public Undertakings	22 = 15 LS + 7 RS	Chair from Lok Sabha	Reports/accounts of public undertakings	Ministers barred

- [ANALYSIS] The trio divides time: Estimates looks forward, PAC audits backward and CoPU specialises by institutional form.

Department-related Standing Committees

- [FACT] The system began with **17 committees in 1993** and was restructured to **24 from 2004**.
- [FACT] Each DRSC has **31 members: 21 Lok Sabha + 10 Rajya Sabha**; **16** are serviced by the Lok Sabha Secretariat and **8** by the Rajya Sabha Secretariat.
- [FACT] Ministers are barred; the term is one year.
- [FACT] They examine demands for grants, referred Bills, annual reports and long-term policy documents.
- [LIMIT] Recommendations are advisory. Bills are not automatically or constitutionally required to be referred.

Visual 29 - DRSC scrutiny loop

MINISTRY

| budget demand | Bill | annual report | policy paper

v

DRSC: evidence -> expert/member questions -> cross-party deliberation

|

v

REPORT AND RECOMMENDATIONS

|

+> Government action-taken response

|

+> better-informed House debate

Weak links: optional referral | one-year term | low attendance | research constraints | non-binding recommendations

Other high-yield committees

Committee	Core function	Exact control/caution
Committee on Subordinate Legislation	Tests whether delegated rule-making stays within legislative authority	This is the 2018 delegated-legislation answer, not PAC
Ethics Committee	Examines unethical conduct of members	Distinct from privilege

Committee	Core function	Exact control/caution
Committee of Privileges	Examines breach of privilege/contempt	Privilege protects institutional function
Committee on Government Assurances	Tracks promises/assurances made by ministers	Follow-up, not financial audit
Business Advisory Committee	Recommends allocation of House time	Does not replace the government's agenda role
Rules Committee	Considers House procedure/rules	House-specific
Committee on Petitions	Processes qualifying petitions	Citizen-to-House channel
Welfare of SCs and STs	30 = 20 LS + 10 RS , one-year term, chair appointed by Speaker	Examines NCSC/NCST reports and Article 335 representation; ministers barred

- [FACT] Ethics and Privileges are separate: unethical conduct need not be a breach of a specific privilege, and privilege proceedings serve institutional functioning.
- [FACT] The Welfare of SCs/STs Committee is a parliamentary committee, not the constitutional National Commissions under Articles 338 and 338A.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - PARLIAMENTARY COMMITTEES: ARCHITECTURE AND EXACT CONTROLS

START / CONCEPT: Parliamentary committees: architecture and exact controls

↓

EXACT TERMS: Public Accounts Committee · Estimates Committee · DRSCs · committee scrutiny · ad hoc committee

↓

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Small cross-party forums take evidence, examine documents and report findings to the Houses.

↓

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: They improve legislative information even though recommendations remain advisory.

↓

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: pAC, Estimates and CoPU have different composition, timing and subjects.

↓

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The central issue is committees provide specialised scrutiny that the full House often lacks time to perform.

SESSION 16 - RAJYA SABHA: EQUAL, UNEQUAL AND EXCLUSIVE POWERS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Rajya Sabha is weaker on money and confidence but equal or distinctive in other fields.

Technical definition: Articles 109, 249, 312 and 368 create a graded rather than uniformly subordinate second chamber.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The central issue is rajya Sabha is weaker on money and confidence but equal or distinctive in other fields.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Rajya Sabha powers
- Article 249
- Article 312
- Money Bill

- **bicameral equality**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Rajya Sabha powers; define Article 249, connect Article 312 with Money Bill to explain the mechanism, and use bicameral equality for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 30 - Power map

Field	Rajya Sabha position relative to Lok Sabha
Ordinary Bills	Equal, subject to joint-sitting mechanism
Constitution Amendment Bills	Equal; each House must separately pass
President and Vice-President elections	Participates under respective constitutional rules
Money Bills	Inferior: recommendation only, fourteen days
Demands for Grants	Discusses but does not vote
Confidence in Union ministry	No removal power; Article 75(3) attaches to Lok Sabha
Joint sitting	Participates, but Lok Sabha's numbers usually dominate
Federal special powers	Rajya Sabha alone initiates Articles 249 and 312

Article 249

- [FACT] By a resolution supported by not less than two-thirds of members present and voting, Rajya Sabha may declare it necessary or expedient in the national interest for Parliament to legislate on a State List matter.
- [FACT] The resolution lasts up to one year and may be renewed; laws continue for six months after the resolution ceases.

Article 312

- [FACT] A two-thirds present-and-voting Rajya Sabha resolution may declare it necessary or expedient in the national interest to create one or more All-India Services common to Union and States.

Visual 31 - Qualified verdict

SECONDARY ON: money + supply + confidence
 CO-EQUAL ON: ordinary law + constitutional amendment
 DISTINCTIVE ON: continuity + federal revision
 EXCLUSIVE ON: Articles 249 and 312

Verdict: supporting second chamber, not subordinate chamber

- [ANALYSIS] Calling Rajya Sabha “secondary” is accurate only for finance and government survival; it is misleading for ordinary law, constitutional amendment and federal functions.
- [LIMIT] Do not add loosely described powers to the list of Rajya Sabha's two exclusive constitutional powers controlled by Core: Articles 249 and 312.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - RAJYA SABHA: EQUAL, UNEQUAL AND EXCLUSIVE POWERS

START / CONCEPT: Rajya Sabha: equal, unequal and exclusive powers

↓

EXACT TERMS: Rajya Sabha powers · Article 249 · Article 312 · Money Bill · bicameral equality

↓

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: It revises ordinary law, shares amendment power and alone initiates two federal resolutions.

↓

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Continuity and federal initiative partly offset Lok Sabha primacy in finance and survival.

↓

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not describe Rajya Sabha as either equal or inferior in every field.

↓

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The central issue is rajya Sabha is weaker on money and confidence but equal or distinctive in other fields.

SESSION 17 - ANTI-DEFECTION, WHIP AND THE INDIVIDUAL PARLIAMENTARIAN

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Anti-defection rules protect stability but can narrow independent legislative judgment.

Technical definition: The Tenth Schedule regulates party exit and whip defiance, with tribunal decisions under review.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The central issue is anti-defection rules protect stability but can narrow independent legislative judgment.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Tenth Schedule
- party whip
- Kihoto Hollohan
- legislator autonomy
- two thirds merger

How to use them: Frame the answer through Tenth Schedule; define party whip, connect Kihoto Hollohan with legislator autonomy to explain the mechanism, and use two thirds merger for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 32 - Incentive chain

Tenth Schedule threat
voluntarily leaving party | defying whip without condonation

↓

party leadership controls legislative vote

↓

+-----+-----+

government stability reduced independent scrutiny

↓ ↓

fewer surprise defeats weaker individual law-maker role

- [FACT] The 52nd Amendment (1985) inserted the Tenth Schedule; the 91st Amendment (2003) deleted the one-third split exception. Only merger supported by at least two-thirds of the legislature party survives.
- [FACT] Party members risk disqualification for voluntarily giving up membership or defying a direction without prior permission and without condonation within fifteen days.
- [FACT] Independents are disqualified on joining any party; nominated members may join within six months but not thereafter without consequence.

- [FACT] *Kihoto Hollohan* (1992) treats the Speaker/Chairman as a tribunal subject to judicial review. *Keisham Meghachandra* (2020) urged ordinarily deciding within about three months and proposed consideration of an independent tribunal.
- [ANALYSIS] The whip stabilises responsible government but turns MPs from deliberators into party vote units when used beyond confidence and core financial matters.
- [LIMIT] Limiting the whip and shifting adjudication are reform proposals, not existing law.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ANTI-DEFECTION, WHIP AND THE INDIVIDUAL PARLIAMENTARIAN

START / CONCEPT: Anti-defection, whip and the individual parliamentarian

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Tenth Schedule · party whip · Kihoto Hollohan · legislator autonomy · two thirds merger

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Party directions shape voting, while Speaker decisions remain subject to constitutional judicial review.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Stability rises, but debate and member-level scrutiny may weaken when whips are overused.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the one-third split exception is gone.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The central issue is anti-defection rules protect stability but can narrow independent legislative judgment.

SESSION 18 - INDIAN PARLIAMENTARY GROUP, IPU AND CPA

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The Indian Parliamentary Group connects Parliament with global and Commonwealth networks.

Technical definition: IPG is India's National Group in the IPU and main India Branch of the CPA.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The central issue is the Indian Parliamentary Group connects Parliament with global and Commonwealth networks.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Indian Parliamentary Group**
- **Inter Parliamentary Union**
- **Commonwealth Parliamentary Association**
- **parliamentary diplomacy**
- **international exchange**

How to use them: Frame the answer through Indian Parliamentary Group; define Inter Parliamentary Union, connect Commonwealth Parliamentary Association with parliamentary diplomacy to explain the mechanism, and use international exchange for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 33 - Inter-parliamentary network

INDIAN PARLIAMENT

|

v

INDIAN PARLIAMENTARY GROUP, formed 1949

|

+--> India's National Group in the INTER-PARLIAMENTARY UNION
| global organisation of national parliaments, founded 1889
|

+--> Main India Branch of the COMMONWEALTH PARLIAMENTARY ASSOCIATION
Commonwealth parliamentary network

- [FACT] All MPs may become IPG members. The Lok Sabha Speaker is ex-officio President; the Deputy Speaker and Rajya Sabha Deputy Chairman are ex-officio Vice-Presidents.
- [FACT] IPG supports exchanges, delegations and parliamentary diplomacy.
- [LIMIT] IPG is not a Ministry of External Affairs organ; IPU represents parliaments, not governments; CPA is Commonwealth-specific while IPU is global.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - INDIAN PARLIAMENTARY GROUP, IPU AND CPA

START / CONCEPT: Indian Parliamentary Group, IPU and CPA

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Indian Parliamentary Group · Inter Parliamentary Union · Commonwealth Parliamentary Association · parliamentary diplomacy · international exchange

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Members use IPG channels for delegations, exchanges and inter-parliamentary dialogue.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Parliamentary diplomacy supplements government diplomacy without becoming an executive ministry function.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: IPU represents parliaments, while CPA is Commonwealth-specific.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The central issue is the Indian Parliamentary Group connects Parliament with global and Commonwealth networks.

SESSION 19 - PARLIAMENTARY DECLINE: DIAGNOSIS, COUNTER-EVIDENCE AND REFORM

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Parliamentary decline describes uneven use of strong powers, requiring diagnosis, counter-evidence and reform.

Technical definition: Executive agenda control, wide whips, disruption, guillotine and optional referral produce ratification risk.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

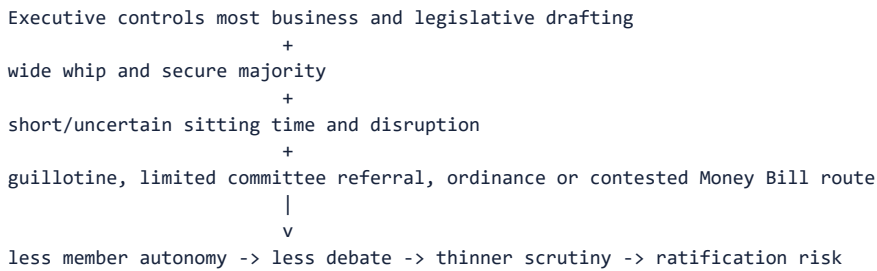
Parliamentary decline must be tested through diagnosis, counter-evidence and matched reform.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **parliamentary decline**
- **executive dominance**
- **committee referral**
- **whip reform**
- **sitting calendar**

How to use them: Frame the answer through parliamentary decline; define executive dominance, connect committee referral with whip reform to explain the mechanism, and use sitting calendar for the decisive comparison or qualification.

Visual 34 - Decline mechanism



Diagnosis

- [ANALYSIS] **Executive agenda dominance:** the government controls most House business and drafts most legislation.
- [ANALYSIS] **Party dominance:** the Tenth Schedule makes rebellion costly and narrows individual judgement.
- [ANALYSIS] **Time scarcity:** disruptions and limited sittings weaken questions, grants and clause-level debate.
- [ANALYSIS] **Bypass/acceleration:** ordinances, guillotine and overbroad Money Bill classification can reduce bicameral scrutiny.
- [ANALYSIS] **Committee erosion:** optional referral and non-binding recommendations weaken the institution best suited to technical scrutiny.

Counter-evidence

- [FACT] No-confidence, questions, motions, bicameral consent, budget authorisation and committee inquiry remain constitutionally available.
- [FACT] PAC-CAG scrutiny can expose financial irregularity; courts review constitutional boundaries; elections renew political responsibility.
- [ANALYSIS] Decline is therefore not institutional extinction. It is a gap between formal capacity and political use.

Visual 35 - Reform matrix

Problem	Reform direction	Qualification
Too little scrutiny time	Predictable calendar and minimum sitting norms	Preserve genuine emergency flexibility
Weak Bill examination	Default DRSC/Select Committee referral with reasoned exceptions	Avoid an absolute rule that blocks urgency
Overbroad whip	Limit compulsory whip to confidence and essential financial votes	Requires legal/political change
Speaker partisanship concerns	Reasoned rulings, timely defection decisions, independent tribunal debate	Neutrality cannot rest on convention alone
Money Bill misuse risk	Apply Article 110's "only" test strictly and preserve narrow judicial review	Do not erase legitimate fiscal procedure
Weak committee capacity	Longer tenure, research staff, attendance and action-taken follow-up	Reports can remain advisory yet influential
Opposition voice	Protect Question Hour, opposition business and chair conventions	Opposition also bears responsibility for functioning

Qualified verdict: [ANALYSIS] Parliament's problem is not absence of power but uneven conversion of power into scrutiny. Reform should change time, incentives and information, not merely add more devices.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - PARLIAMENTARY DECLINE: DIAGNOSIS, COUNTER-EVIDENCE AND REFORM

START / CONCEPT: Parliamentary decline: diagnosis, counter-evidence and reform

|

v

EXACT TERMS: parliamentary decline · executive dominance · committee referral · whip reform · sitting calendar

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Diagnose the constraint, identify the lost scrutiny function and match it to a targeted reform.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Better time, information and incentives can activate existing powers without inventing new devices.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Decline means uneven political use, not disappearance of constitutional authority.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Parliamentary decline must be tested through diagnosis, counter-evidence and matched reform.

SESSION 20 - LIVE UNIT: 106TH AMENDMENT, CENSUS 2027 AND DELIMITATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The womens reservation amendment is in force but its seat reservation is not yet operational.

Technical definition: Article 334A requires published post-commencement census figures and purpose-specific delimitation.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The central issue is the womens reservation amendment is in force but its seat reservation is not yet operational.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- 106th Amendment
- Article 334A
- Census 2027
- womens reservation
- delimitation

How to use them: Frame the answer through 106th Amendment; define Article 334A, connect Census 2027 with womens reservation to explain the mechanism, and use delimitation for the decisive comparison or qualification.

A. Three registers that must never be merged

Visual 36 - Women's reservation status registers

REGISTER 1: ENACTED / INCORPORATED
September 2023 assent; Articles 330A, 332A and 334A in Constitution

|

v

REGISTER 2: COMMENCED
16 April 2026 notification under section 1(2)

|

v

REGISTER 3: OPERATIONAL RESERVATION
NOT YET

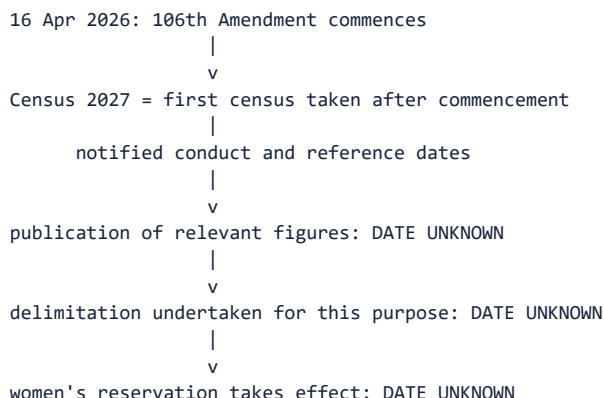
requires publication of relevant first post-commencement census figures
-> delimitation undertaken for this purpose -> reservation takes effect

- [FACT] The 106th Amendment provides one-third reservation for women in Lok Sabha, State Legislative Assemblies and the Delhi Legislative Assembly, including within SC/ST-reserved seats.
- [FACT] It commenced on 16 April 2026.

- [FACT] Article 334A(1) makes operationalisation contingent on delimitation undertaken for this purpose after publication of relevant figures of the first census taken after commencement.
- [FACT] Article 334A(2) permits continuance as Parliament may by law determine; Article 334A(3) links rotation to each subsequent delimitation.
- [LIMIT] Quote the duration phrase as “**fifteen years from such commencement**”. Do not derive a 2041 end date because the referent of “such commencement” is contested in commentary.
- [LIMIT] Commencement is not operationalisation; no seat is presently reserved under these provisions.

B. Census 2027 controls

Visual 37 - Trigger sequence



Census control	Official position	Limit
Houselisting and Housing Census	1 April-30 September 2026 window; each State/UT chooses a fixed 30-day period	Do not claim a single nationwide completion date
Population Enumeration	February 2027 generally; September 2026 in identified snow-bound areas	Enumeration is not publication
Reference date	00:00 on 1 March 2027 generally	Snow-bound reference date differs
Snow-bound reference date	00:00 on 1 October 2026	Keep both reference dates separate
Design	First fully digital census; self-enumeration; caste enumeration announced	Do not predict findings or legal use
Legal frame	Census Act, 1948 and Census Rules, 1990	The census is statutory; Articles 82/334A borrow its figures

- [FACT] Census 2027 is also the first census after 2026 relevant to the 84th Amendment/Article 82 readjustment trigger.
- [LIMIT] Conduct date, reference date and publication date are different. The constitutional trigger turns on **publication**.

C. The defeated 2026 delimitation package

Visual 38 - Legislative event timeline

16 APRIL 2026: introduced in Lok Sabha
Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill
Delimitation Bill
Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill

17 APRIL 2026: constitutional amendment division
298 for | 230 against | 528 present and voting

Article 368 tests
majority of total membership: cleared
two-thirds present and voting: not cleared (needed about 352)

RESULT: amendment defeated; linked Bills did not pass

- [FACT] The amendment Bill proposed raising the Article 81 ceiling from 550 to **850**: up to 815 State seats and 35 UT seats.
- [FACT] It proposed permitting Parliament to determine the census figures used, with an immediate exercise on 2011 Census figures, and sought to advance operationalisation of the women's quota.
- [FACT] 298 votes exceeded a majority of the total elected strength of 543 but fell short of two-thirds of 528 present and voting.
- [ANALYSIS] The episode cleanly proves that a government majority is not an Article 368 amending majority.
- [LIMIT] Every number above belongs only to the defeated Bill/event. Existing Article 81 ceiling remains 550; existing elected Lok Sabha strength remains 543; Article 334A remains unchanged.
- [LIMIT] Do not say the Bill "lost the division": it received more ayes than noes but failed the special-majority threshold.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - LIVE UNIT: 106TH AMENDMENT, CENSUS 2027 AND DELIMITATION

START / CONCEPT: Live unit: 106th Amendment, Census 2027 and delimitation

EXACT TERMS: 106th Amendment • Article 334A • Census 2027 • womens reservation • delimitation

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Commencement is followed by census publication and delimitation before reserved seats take effect.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The sequence links representation reform to an unresolved demographic and federal bargain.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The defeated 850-seat proposal and 2011 census basis are not existing law.

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The central issue is the womens reservation amendment is in force but its seat reservation is not yet operational.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Original MCQ loop - strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation

OM1. Constitutional composition

Parliament under Article 79 consists of:

A. President, Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha B. Prime Minister, Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha C. President and Lok Sabha only D. Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha only

Answer: A. [FACT] The President is an integral organ of Parliament though not a member of either House.

OM2. Rajya Sabha election

Which correctly describes election of elected Rajya Sabha members from States?

A. Direct FPTP through territorial constituencies B. Proportional representation by single transferable vote through elected MLAs C. List proportional representation through all adults D. Nomination by Governors after Assembly consultation

Answer: B. [FACT] Elected MLAs form the electorate; the 2003 statutory change introduced open ballot.

OM3. Seat-freeze extension

Which amendment extended readjustment until publication of figures of the first census taken after 2026?

A. 42nd Amendment B. 61st Amendment C. 84th Amendment D. 87th Amendment

Answer: C. [FACT] The 42nd began the freeze; the 84th extended it; the 87th changed the boundary-readjustment census basis to 2001.

OM4. Lok Sabha nomination

Which statement is correct?

A. Anglo-Indian nomination was converted into Rajya Sabha nomination. B. Lok Sabha has twelve nominated members. C. The President may presently nominate two Anglo-Indians to Lok Sabha. D. The 104th Amendment ended the Anglo-Indian nomination provision for Lok Sabha.

Answer: D. [FACT] Present Lok Sabha composition has no nominated Anglo-Indian members.

OM5. Article 84

Which is a constitutional qualification for Parliament membership?

A. Citizenship of India B. Prior legislative experience C. Graduation from a recognised university D. Residence for ten years in the represented State

Answer: A. [FACT] Citizenship, prescribed oath, minimum age and statutory qualifications form the gate.

OM6. Sitting-member disqualification

Who decides an Article 102(1) question concerning a sitting MP?

A. Speaker acting alone B. President after obtaining the Election Commission's opinion C. Supreme Court in original jurisdiction D. Returning Officer

Answer: B. [FACT] Article 103 creates the President-ECI decision route.

OM7. Leader of Opposition

Which statement best reflects the Core control?

A. LoP is appointed by the President. B. LoP is a purely constitutional office named in Article 75. C. LoP is statutory under the 1977 Act; the Act itself prescribes no ten-percent threshold. D. The largest opposition leader automatically becomes LoP in all circumstances.

Answer: C. [FACT] Distinguish the statutory recognised office from the political leader of the largest opposition party.

OM8. Prorogation

Prorogation:

A. Causes every pending Bill to lapse. B. Is ordered by the Speaker. C. Ends the life of Lok Sabha. D. Ends a session through presidential action while pending Bills generally survive.

Answer: D. [FACT] Adjournment is by the chair; dissolution, not prorogation, ends Lok Sabha.

OM9. Starred question

A starred question ordinarily:

A. Receives an oral answer and permits supplementary questions. B. Cannot concern a ministry. C. Is identical to Zero Hour. D. Receives only a written answer.

Answer: A. [FACT] Oral follow-up makes starred questions the principal live cross-examination device.

OM10. No-confidence motion

Which is correct?

A. Its defeat dissolves Rajya Sabha. B. It belongs only to Lok Sabha and needs support of 50 members for admission. C. It must specify charges against each minister. D. It can be moved in either House.

Answer: B. [FACT] Article 75(3) ties collective responsibility to Lok Sabha; reasons need not be stated.

OM11. Speaker after dissolution

On dissolution of Lok Sabha, the Speaker:

A. Vacates immediately with all members. B. Continues for six months. C. Continues until immediately before the first sitting of the new Lok Sabha. D. Becomes a Rajya Sabha officer.

Answer: C. [FACT] Article 94 preserves institutional continuity.

OM12. Speaker's removal resolution

While a resolution for the Speaker's removal is considered:

A. The Speaker cannot enter the House. B. The Deputy Speaker cannot preside. C. The Speaker presides and uses only a casting vote. D. The Speaker does not preside, may vote in the first instance and has no casting vote.

Answer: D. [FACT] Article 96 removes the conflict in presiding, not the member's right to participate.

OM13. Sita Soren

The 2024 seven-judge ruling establishes that:

A. Legislative privilege does not immunise acceptance of a bribe for speech or vote. B. Only actual voting, not bribe acceptance, can complete bribery. C. Article 105 has been invalidated. D. All parliamentary speech may be criminally prosecuted.

Answer: A. [FACT] The offence is complete on acceptance; bona fide speech/vote immunity survives.

OM14. Ordinary Bill deadlock

Which is a recognised Article 108 trigger?

A. States refuse to ratify an amendment. B. The second House rejects an ordinary Bill or the Houses finally disagree. C. President returns a Bill. D. Rajya Sabha recommends changes to a Money Bill.

Answer: B. [FACT] Eligible deadlocks include rejection, final disagreement and specified delay; Money and amendment Bills are excluded.

OM15. Money Bill

Which condition is essential?

A. A joint sitting resolves disagreement. B. Rajya Sabha must consent within fourteen days. C. It must contain only Article 110 matters and incidental provisions. D. It may include any policy matter if taxation is also present.

Answer: C. [FACT] "Only" is the classification firewall; Rajya Sabha recommendations are non-binding.

OM16. Financial Bill-II

Which statement is correct?

A. It can originate only in Lok Sabha. B. Rajya Sabha has recommendation-only power. C. It is always a Money Bill. D. It may originate in either House, with presidential recommendation required before consideration.

Answer: D. [FACT] Article 117(3) differs from both Money Bill and Financial Bill-I.

OM17. Joint-sitting history

How many joint sittings had been held according to the controlled Core?

A. Three B. Five C. One D. Four

Answer: A. [FACT] Dowry 1961, Banking Service 1978 and POTA 2002.

OM18. Bill lapse

Which Bill lapses on Lok Sabha dissolution?

A. Bill for which joint sitting was notified B. Bill passed by Lok Sabha but pending in Rajya Sabha C. Bill passed by both Houses awaiting assent D. Bill pending in Rajya Sabha and never passed by Lok Sabha

Answer: B. [FACT] It carries the expired Lok Sabha's unfinished mandate.

OM19. Charged expenditure

Charged expenditure on the Consolidated Fund:

A. Is voted by both Houses. B. Is neither discussed nor voted. C. May be discussed but is not submitted to vote. D. Is voted only by Rajya Sabha.

Answer: C. [FACT] The non-votable character protects specified constitutional expenditures while allowing discussion.

OM20. Token cut

A Token Cut Motion reduces a demand by:

A. Ten per cent B. Re 1 C. The full disputed amount D. Rs 100

Answer: D. [FACT] Re 1 is Policy Cut; Token Cut ventilates a specific grievance.

OM21. Public Account

Which fund does not require parliamentary appropriation for withdrawal?

A. Public Account of India B. Consolidated Fund of India C. Contingency Fund after recoupment D. Every constitutional fund requires identical appropriation

Answer: A. [FACT] Public Account contains money held in trust; Consolidated Fund withdrawal requires appropriation.

OM22. PAC

Which correctly describes PAC?

A. 30 Lok Sabha members; prospective estimates scrutiny B. 22 members (15 LS + 7 RS); examines CAG reports; Opposition chair by convention C. 22 members; examines only private corporations D. 31 members; every ministry has a separate PAC

Answer: B. [FACT] PAC is retrospective audit scrutiny; ministers are barred.

OM23. Estimates Committee

Which is correct?

A. It decides whether expenditure was legally authorised after the fact. B. It is conventionally chaired by the Opposition. C. It has 30 Lok Sabha members and examines economy/efficiency in estimates. D. It has seven Rajya Sabha members.

Answer: C. [FACT] PAC handles post-expenditure CAG audit; Estimates is Lok Sabha-only and prospective.

OM24. DRSC composition

Each DRSC has:

A. 30 members: 20 LS + 10 RS B. 22 members: 15 LS + 7 RS C. 31 members: 20 LS + 11 RS D. 31 members: 21 LS + 10 RS

Answer: D. [FACT] There were 17 in 1993 and 24 from 2004; 16 are LS-serviced and 8 RS-serviced.

OM25. Welfare of SCs/STs Committee

Which is correct?

A. It has 30 members (20 LS + 10 RS) and examines NCSC/NCST reports and Article 335 representation. B. It is the same institution as the NCSC. C. Ministers must constitute half its membership. D. It has only Lok Sabha members.

Answer: A. [FACT] It is a standing parliamentary committee; ministers are barred.

OM26. Rajya Sabha's exclusive powers

The controlled pair is:

A. Articles 75 and 113 B. Articles 249 and 312 C. Articles 110 and 123 D. Articles 108 and 111

Answer: B. [FACT] Rajya Sabha initiates national-interest State List legislation and creation of All-India Services.

OM27. Anti-defection merger

Which threshold supports the surviving merger exception?

A. Half of members present B. One-third of the House C. At least two-thirds of the legislature party D. Unanimous party membership

Answer: C. [FACT] The 91st Amendment deleted the former one-third split defence.

OM28. Nominated member under Tenth Schedule

Which statement is correct?

A. The rule is identical to that for an independent. B. A nominated member can never join a party. C. A nominated member may join at any time without consequence. D. A nominated member may join within six months; joining after that can disqualify.

Answer: D. [FACT] An independent is disqualified upon joining any party.

OM29. IPG

The Indian Parliamentary Group:

A. Is India's National Group in the IPU and main India Branch of the CPA. B. Is limited to Rajya Sabha members. C. Is a wing of the Ministry of External Affairs. D. Represents governments at the United Nations.

Answer: A. [FACT] IPG organises parliamentary exchange; IPU is global and CPA Commonwealth-specific.

OM30. 106th Amendment status

As of 28 August 2026:

A. One-third of current Lok Sabha seats are already reserved. B. It commenced on 16 April 2026, but the reservation remains non-operational pending the Article 334A sequence. C. The quota necessarily ends in 2041. D. The Act has not commenced.

Answer: B. [FACT] Commenced and operational are different registers; no end year should be derived.

OM31. Census trigger

What must occur immediately before delimitation can switch on the Article 334A reservation sequence?

A. Completion of houselisting alone B. Reference date of 1 March 2027 C. Publication of the relevant figures of the first post-commencement census D. Passage of an ordinary resolution

Answer: C. [FACT] Enumeration/reference dates are not publication dates.

OM32. 2026 delimitation package

Which statement is correct?

A. Lok Sabha's ceiling is now 850. B. The package created a binding precedent. C. Delimitation must now use the 2011 Census. D. The 131st Amendment Bill proposed 850 but was defeated for want of the Article 368 special majority.

Answer: D. [FACT] 298:230 cleared the total-membership limb but not two-thirds of 528 present and voting.

OM33. Money Bill judicial status

Which is the safest current formulation?

A. Article 110 says final, but narrow constitutional review remains and the *Rojer Mathew* larger issue has no visible final resolution as of 28 August 2026. B. *Puttaswamy* unanimously settled every Article 110 issue. C. Speaker certification is wholly immune from courts. D. *Rojer Mathew* finally invalidated all Money Bills.

Answer: A. [FACT]/[CURRENT] The formulation preserves textual finality, narrow review and pending-status caution.

OM34. Deputy Speaker

Which statement is correct?

A. The office automatically falls vacant on every adjournment. B. The House elects the Deputy Speaker, who has the Speaker's powers when presiding. C. The Deputy Speaker is appointed by the Speaker. D. The Constitution fixes a thirty-day election deadline.

Answer: B. [FACT] Article 93 says "as soon as may be" but supplies no numerical deadline.

OM35. Parliamentary reform

Which reform most directly improves clause-level legislative scrutiny?

- A. Abolishing Rajya Sabha B. Treating every Bill as a Money Bill C. Default committee referral with reasoned urgency exceptions D. Expanding every whip to every vote

Answer: C. [ANALYSIS] It targets the point where evidence and legal text can be tested without destroying emergency flexibility.

OM36. MPLADS

Which statement follows the controlled routed demand?

- A. The current annual amount may be quoted without checking. B. Its funds necessarily lapse at year-end. C. MPLADS is a constitutional entitlement. D. It is a scheme with non-lapsable funds; current rupee amount requires live official verification.

Answer: D. [FACT]/[LIMIT] Stable scheme characteristics can be stated; live amounts cannot be guessed.

Remedial MCQs - strict A -> B -> A -> D rotation

RM1. President and membership

Which correction is accurate?

- A. The President is an integral part of Parliament but not a member of either House. B. Parliament excludes the President. C. The President votes in joint sittings. D. The President is a nominated Rajya Sabha member.

Answer: A. The Article 79 architecture distinguishes institutional membership from being an integral constitutional organ.

RM2. Session rule

The Constitution requires:

- A. At least 100 Lok Sabha sitting days B. No more than six months between the relevant sittings of successive sessions C. Exactly three sessions every year D. A Winter Session every November

Answer: B. Budget/Monsoon/Winter are conventions; Article 85 supplies the six-month ceiling, not a sitting-day quota.

RM3. Prorogation trap

What ordinarily happens to a pending Bill on prorogation?

- A. It lapses if introduced by a private member. B. It becomes an ordinance. C. It survives. D. It goes automatically to joint sitting.

Answer: C. Prorogation ends a session; dissolution creates the selective lapse rules.

RM4. Speaker removal

Which statement is correct?

- A. Speaker must preside over the resolution. B. No advance notice is required. C. Removal uses a simple majority of members present and voting. D. Removal needs a majority of all the then members after fourteen days' notice.

Answer: D. This is an effective majority; Article 96 separately bars the Speaker from presiding.

RM5. Financial Bill-I trap

A Financial Bill-I:

A. Starts only in Lok Sabha on presidential recommendation, but Rajya Sabha retains full legislative power. B. Cannot go to joint sitting. C. Is always subject to the fourteen-day recommendation rule. D. Contains only Article 110 matters.

Answer: A. The presence of other matters takes it outside the narrow Money Bill procedure.

RM6. Joint-sitting exclusion

Which pair has no joint-sitting route?

A. Government Bill and Private Member's Bill B. Money Bill and Constitution Amendment Bill C. Ordinary Bill and Financial Bill-I D. Ordinary Bill and Financial Bill-II

Answer: B. Money Bills have Article 109 procedure; amendments require separate Article 368 passage.

RM7. Committee-number trap

Which statement is correct?

A. Estimates Committee has 15 LS and 7 RS members. B. Welfare of SCs/STs Committee has 31 members. C. DRSCs were 17 in 1993 and 24 from 2004; each has 21 LS and 10 RS members. D. DRSCs were 24 from their introduction in 1993.

Answer: C. The standard distractors wrongly backdate 24 or swap the 21+10 composition.

RM8. Privilege trap

After *Sita Soren*:

A. Article 105 was repealed judicially. B. No speech in Parliament is protected. C. Members have immunity for a bribe if they later vote. D. Bribery lacks privilege immunity, while bona fide speech/vote protection remains.

Answer: D. The judgment targets the separate criminal bargain, not legislative freedom of debate.

RM9. Rajya Sabha status

Which statement is most accurate?

A. Rajya Sabha is weaker on money/confidence, equal in major legislative fields and exclusive under Articles 249/312. B. Rajya Sabha may remove the Union ministry. C. Rajya Sabha is inferior in every field. D. Rajya Sabha alone votes demands for grants.

Answer: A. A graded comparison is required; blanket equality or inferiority is wrong.

RM10. Women's reservation trap

Which is correct as of 28 August 2026?

A. The Act remains uncommenced. B. The Act commenced, but operational reservation awaits publication-linked delimitation. C. Its end date is conclusively 2041. D. Reservation automatically began with Census houselisting.

Answer: B. Enacted, commenced and operational are three separate registers.

RM11. 2026 Bill arithmetic

The 131st Amendment Bill failed because:

A. Rajya Sabha rejected it after Lok Sabha passage. B. It failed the total-membership-majority limb. C. It cleared a simple majority but failed two-thirds of members present and voting. D. It received fewer ayes than noes.

Answer: C. 298 exceeded half of 543 but not two-thirds of 528; it never reached Rajya Sabha.

RM12. Deputy Speaker status

Which statement is correct on the official Lok Sabha control checked 28 August 2026?

A. The Constitution requires election within thirty days. B. The Deputy Speaker's office is permanently abolished. C. The official page dates the vacancy from 2018. D. The office is vacant, and the official page dates the vacancy from May 2019.

Answer: D. Article 93 governs election by the House; the vacancy statement is a dated official control and must not be converted into a timeless constitutional rule.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Answer-writing architecture

Visual 39 - Mandatory answer spine

CLAIM
directly answer the directive
|
NAMED EVIDENCE
Article / case / committee / amendment / dated official event
|
ANALYSIS
explain mechanism, consequence or significance
|
QUALIFICATION
state counter-evidence, status limit or variation
|
VERDICT
graded answer to the exact question

Directive fidelity

Directive	Required operation	Common failure
Discuss	Explain major dimensions with balance	Mere list
Examine	Test the proposition using evidence	One-sided assertion
Evaluate	Apply criteria, strengths and weaknesses, then judge	Description without judgment
To what extent	Give a degree-based answer	Absolute yes/no
Highlight factors and areas	Separate causes from fields of effect	Mixing both
Elucidate	Clarify mechanism with evidence	Generic merits/demerits

Mark-scaled evidence load

Marks/words	Structure	Named evidence target
10 / 150	Thesis -> 2-3 mechanisms -> one qualification -> verdict	2-3 precise Articles/cases/committees
15 / 250	Thesis -> 4-5 dimensions -> counterpoint -> verdict	4-6 named units
20 / 250	Thesis -> architecture -> causes -> consequences -> counterevidence -> reform -> graded verdict	5-8 named units

Reusable answer spines

- **Executive accountability:** Article 75(3) -> questions/discussions -> motions -> budget -> committees -> whip/time limits -> degree-based verdict.
- **Rajya Sabha:** money/confidence subordination -> ordinary/amendment equality -> Articles 249/312 -> continuity/federal role -> supporting-not-subordinate verdict.
- **Speaker:** Articles 93-97 -> rule/Money Bill/defection powers -> British convention contrast -> judicial/structural limits -> reform.
- **Committees:** standing/ad hoc -> financial trio -> DRSCs -> usefulness -> advisory/referral weaknesses -> strengthen, not bypass.
- **Decline:** whip -> executive calendar -> guillotine/referral decline -> bypass routes -> counter-instruments -> reforms.
- **Money Bill:** Article 110 "only" -> Article 109 procedure -> Speaker certificate -> *Puttaswamy/Rojer Mathew* -> federal cost -> qualified pending-status verdict.

Solved directly routed Mains PYQs

Provenance rule: The seven 2018-2023 demands are routed by the audited Core owner. The 2024 GS-II Q3 wording is verified in the cross-owned Polity 11/16 packages. Neutral wording is used where exact UPSC wording has not been independently reproduced here.

PYQ-M1. 2018 GS-II Q4 - Usefulness of parliamentary committees, especially the Estimates Committee

Demand decoding

- "Discuss" requires functions, usefulness, limitations and a balanced conclusion.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** use three institutional units, not a catalogue of every committee.

Model answer

Claim: Parliamentary committees are indispensable "working rooms" of Parliament because they preserve detailed scrutiny when plenary time is scarce.

Named evidence: The **Estimates Committee** has **30 Lok Sabha members**, excludes ministers and examines budget estimates for economy, efficiency and administrative improvement. It complements the **PAC**, which audits CAG findings after expenditure, and **CoPU**, which specialises in public undertakings. The **24 DRSCs**, each with 21 Lok Sabha and 10 Rajya Sabha members, examine demands for grants, referred Bills and ministry reports.

Analysis: Small membership, evidence-taking, continuity and less theatrical party competition allow technical and often cross-party scrutiny. Estimates scrutiny is preventive: it asks whether public money can be spent better before audit identifies failure.

Qualification: Reports are advisory; attendance, research support and Bill referral vary. Estimates recommendations cannot themselves alter grants.

Verdict: Committees do not replace the House, but they make its financial and legislative control credible. Routine referral and stronger follow-up would increase their usefulness.

Examiner note: Exact Estimates-PAC-CoPU differentiation, DRSC evidence and one limitation make this complete rather than descriptive.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 3 named committee units plus a qualified verdict.

Why this earns marks: Exact committee differentiation, causal usefulness and a bounded advisory-status verdict satisfy the directive.

How to improve this answer: If compressed, retain Estimates 30 LS-only, PAC-CAG, one DRSC function and the advisory/referral limit; drop the wider committee catalogue.

PYQ-M2. 2019 GS-II Q15 - Decline of the individual parliamentarian and debate quality

Demand decoding

- “Discuss” requires mechanisms causing decline, surviving opportunities and reforms.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** separate member autonomy, House time and scrutiny quality.

Model answer

Claim: The individual MP's law-making role has declined because party and executive institutions increasingly determine both the vote and the agenda.

Named evidence and analysis: First, the **Tenth Schedule** makes defiance of a party direction potentially disqualifying. This stabilises government but converts many legislative choices into party commands. Second, the executive controls most government business and drafting; limited sitting time, disruption and the **guillotine** can pass demands without discussion. Third, fewer or selective referrals to **DRSCs** remove the main site for clause-level, evidence-based scrutiny. Fourth, ordinances under **Article 123** and an overbroad **Article 110** Money Bill route can compress prior bicameral deliberation. Finally, the rarity of successful Private Members' Bills signals limited non-government law-making space.

Counter-evidence: MPs still use starred questions, Zero Hour, motions, committee reports, amendments and constituency knowledge. Rajya Sabha scrutiny and opposition-led PAC work can produce institutional effects even without defeating the government.

Qualification: Decline varies with majority size, coalition politics, committee referral and presiding-officer practice; it is not a constitutional disappearance of the MP.

Verdict: The parliamentarian has shifted from autonomous law-maker toward party-linked scrutiniser. Predictable sittings, default committee referral and a whip confined to confidence/core finance would restore deliberation without destabilising government.

Examiner note: The answer explains the causal chain and acknowledges surviving agency; it does not confuse low autonomy with legal powerlessness.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 230-250 words; 5 mechanisms, 2 counter-instruments and 3 reforms.

Why this earns marks: The answer explains the whip-agenda-time causal chain, preserves surviving MP agency and closes with feasible reforms.

How to improve this answer: For 150 words, keep Tenth Schedule, executive agenda, one scrutiny loss and one reform; for 250 words retain counter-evidence and variation by majority size.

PYQ-M3. 2020 GS-II Q5 - “Once a Speaker, always a Speaker” and objectivity

Demand decoding

- Answer both parts: whether the convention operates in India and its implications for objectivity.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** one institutional contrast, three powers, one reform.

Model answer

Claim: The British convention that a Speaker severs party ties and is normally returned unopposed does not operate in India; therefore neutrality rests more on individual conduct than institutional insulation.

Named evidence: Under **Articles 93-97**, the Speaker controls procedure and discipline. The office also certifies a Money Bill under **Article 110**, presides over an **Article 108** joint sitting and decides Tenth Schedule petitions subject to *Kihoto Hollohan*. The Speaker retains party membership and ordinarily contests again on a party ticket.

Analysis: These high-stakes powers can affect bicameralism, government survival and member status. A party-linked career therefore creates a perception of bias even when a decision is legally defensible. Delayed defection rulings and disputed Money Bill certification intensify the concern.

Qualification: Article 94 continuity after dissolution, charged salary and House removal safeguards provide some independence; party origin does not prove actual partisanship.

Verdict: “Once a Speaker, always a Speaker” is aspirational, not Indian practice. Reasoned rulings, political detachment and independent defection adjudication would make objectivity structural.

Examiner note: Direct convention answer plus powers-mechanism-qualification sequence satisfies both limbs.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 3 named powers and one balanced reform.

Why this earns marks: It answers both the comparative-convention and objectivity limbs through three high-stakes powers and a qualified institutional judgment.

How to improve this answer: Compress to Article 110, Tenth Schedule and party-linked career; improve further by separating perceived bias from proof of bias in one explicit sentence.

PYQ-M4. 2020 GS-II Q14 - Rajya Sabha as a supporting organ

Demand decoding

- "Highlight factors and areas" requires separate treatment of causes and fields of subordination.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** avoid the absolute claim that Rajya Sabha is inferior everywhere.

Model answer

Claim: Rajya Sabha is a supporting chamber in finance and confidence, but a co-equal or distinctive chamber in ordinary law, constitutional amendment and federal protection.

Areas of subordination: Under **Articles 109-110**, it can only recommend changes to a Money Bill within fourteen days. It cannot vote demands for grants, and **Article 75(3)** gives only Lok Sabha the confidence key. In an **Article 108** joint sitting, Lok Sabha's larger numbers usually prevail.

Factors: Direct election gives Lok Sabha stronger popular legitimacy; executive survival is tied to its majority; and disputed use of the Money Bill route can bypass the Upper House. Political disruption and limited referral can further weaken revision.

Counter-evidence: Rajya Sabha has equal power over ordinary Bills and **Article 368** amendments. As a permanent House it supplies continuity. Its two exclusive powers - **Article 249** State List legislation in the national interest and **Article 312** creation of All-India Services - make it a federal gatekeeper. It also shares committee scrutiny and national debate.

Qualification: State representation is population-weighted, not equal-per-State; its federal design is therefore weaker than a senate based on State equality.

Verdict: Rajya Sabha supports Lok Sabha without being subordinate to it. The label is accurate only where the Constitution deliberately prioritises popular control over money and government survival.

Examiner note: Separates "factors" from "areas" and gives a degree-based verdict with Articles 249/312.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 230-250 words; 3 subordinate fields, 4 counterweights and one design caveat.

Why this earns marks: The graded equal-unequal-exclusive structure directly answers both factors and areas without reducing Rajya Sabha to a uniformly inferior chamber.

How to improve this answer: Under time pressure use a three-row power matrix, then add Articles 249/312 and the population-weighted federal caveat before the verdict.

PYQ-M5. 2021 GS-II Q4 - Extent of Parliament's executive accountability

Demand decoding

- "To what extent" demands a graded judgment, not a list of devices.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** instruments -> limits -> degree-based verdict.

Model answer

Claim: Parliament possesses a comprehensive accountability toolkit, but its effectiveness is conditional on time, information and party incentives.

Named evidence: Starred questions and supplementaries compel ministerial explanation; Zero Hour, Calling Attention and motions expose policy failure. **Article 75(3)** enables Lok Sabha no-confidence control. **Articles 112-114** require budget presentation, voting of grants and appropriation. **PAC-CAG** audit and **DRSC** scrutiny extend control

beyond the floor.

Analysis: These instruments cover the full administrative cycle - information, authorisation, ongoing criticism, financial audit and ultimate removal.

Qualification: A secure majority and the Tenth Schedule make government defeat unlikely. Disruptions, the guillotine, limited sitting days, selective committee referral and ordinances can weaken scrutiny.

Verdict: Accountability is constitutionally strong but behaviourally uneven: Parliament usually extracts information and audit, yet only exceptionally threatens executive survival. Protected scrutiny time and stronger committees would narrow the gap.

Examiner note: "Extent" is answered explicitly by distinguishing routine oversight from survival control.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 4 evidence families and 4 limitations.

Why this earns marks: A clear extent judgment distinguishes routine information/audit control from the exceptional survival sanction.

How to improve this answer: Retain Article 75(3), one financial-control chain, one committee and two operating limits; do not spend words cataloguing every motion.

PYQ-M6. 2021 GS-II Q15 - Working of DRSCs in enforcing executive control

Demand decoding

- "Evaluate" requires criteria: design, performance, weaknesses and final assessment.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** exact composition is essential.

Model answer

Claim: DRSCs are Parliament's most capable instrument of continuous ministry-wise oversight, but they enforce control through information and persuasion rather than binding command.

Named evidence: Introduced as **17 committees in 1993** and restructured to **24 from 2004**, each now has **31 members - 21 Lok Sabha and 10 Rajya Sabha**; sixteen are Lok Sabha-secretariat serviced and eight Rajya Sabha-secretariat serviced. Ministers are barred. They examine demands for grants, referred Bills, annual reports and long-term policy.

Analysis: Their smaller forum permits evidence-taking, clause scrutiny, technical learning and cross-party consensus away from floor grandstanding. Demand-for-grants reports connect policy priorities with spending; Bill reports improve legal design; action-taken reports sustain follow-up.

Weaknesses: Referral is not automatic, recommendations are non-binding, terms are only one year, attendance and research support can be weak, and the government may provide delayed or formalistic responses. Major Bills passed without referral show that effectiveness depends on executive and presiding-officer choices.

Qualification: Non-binding status is not uselessness: reasoned reports shape debate, media and later policy, while final law and supply must remain with the House.

Verdict: DRSCs work effectively when used, but are under-used. Default referral, longer specialisation, expert staff and public reasons for bypass would convert potential into systematic control.

Examiner note: Exact 1993/2004 and 21+10 controls, functions and enforceability distinction produce an evaluative answer.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 235-250 words; 4 functions, 5 weaknesses and 4 reforms.

Why this earns marks: Exact 17-to-24 chronology, 21+10 composition, functions and non-binding influence provide evaluative rather than descriptive depth.

How to improve this answer: If shortening, preserve composition, demands/Bill scrutiny, optional referral and one reform; remove generic praise before removing institutional evidence.

PYQ-M7. 2023 GS-II Q16 - Committee structure and role of financial committees

Demand decoding

- “Explain the structure” requires classification before evaluating the financial arm.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** use exact committee compositions.

Model answer

Claim: Parliament’s committee system combines permanent subject/House oversight with task-specific inquiry; its financial committees operationalise the constitutional power of the purse.

Structure: Standing committees include financial committees, 24 DRSCs, House-management committees and oversight bodies such as Subordinate Legislation, Privileges, Ethics, Government Assurances and Welfare of SCs/STs. **Ad hoc committees** include Select/Joint Committees on Bills and JPCs formed for a specified inquiry.

Named financial evidence: The **PAC** has **22 members (15 LS + 7 RS)**, is conventionally chaired by the Opposition and examines CAG reports after expenditure. The **Estimates Committee** has **30 Lok Sabha members only** and seeks economy and administrative improvement before or during expenditure planning. **CoPU** has **22 members (15+7)** and specialises in public undertakings. Ministers are barred from all three.

Analysis: Estimates supplies prospective efficiency scrutiny, PAC retrospective legality/regularity scrutiny and CoPU institution-specific commercial accountability. DRSC examination of demands bridges these stages.

Qualification: Reports are advisory, PAC ordinarily avoids questioning policy itself and referral/follow-up may be weak.

Verdict: The structure substitutes depth for scarce floor time; its financial arm closes the authorisation-audit loop but needs stronger research and action-taken enforcement.

Examiner note: Begins with the required architecture, then explains rather than merely names each financial committee.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 230-250 words; classification plus exact 22/30/22 evidence.

Why this earns marks: Classification precedes the exact financial trio, and prospective, retrospective and undertaking-specific roles are analytically separated.

How to improve this answer: Use a standing-versus-ad-hoc opening, then PAC 15+7, Estimates 30 LS-only and CoPU 15+7; end with advisory-status and follow-up limits.

PYQ-M8. 2024 GS-II Q3 - Cabinet growth and marginalisation of parliamentary supremacy

Demand decoding

- “Elucidate” requires a mechanism showing how cabinet growth affects Parliament.
- “Parliamentary supremacy” must mean effective control/deliberation, not UK-style legal sovereignty.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** three mechanisms, correctives and qualified verdict.

Model answer

Claim: The cabinet remains responsible to Lok Sabha under **Article 75(3)**, yet fusion of executive and legislature can let a disciplined cabinet majority dominate the institution meant to control it.

Named evidence and analysis: The Tenth Schedule whip reduces independent voting; the government controls most Bills and House time; guillotining demands, selective DRSC referral and compressed debate weaken scrutiny. Ordinances under **Article 123** and an overbroad **Article 110** route can reduce prior legislative and bicameral examination. PMO-centred coordination may add prime-ministerial dominance over cabinet dominance.

Qualification: Parliament still authorises supply, may remove the ministry, asks questions and uses PAC-CAG/DRSC scrutiny. Courts enforce constitutional limits and elections renew responsibility.

Verdict: Cabinet growth has marginalised Parliament’s deliberative and control functions, not transferred constitutional sovereignty. Predictable sittings, routine committee scrutiny and narrower whip use can restore responsible fusion.

Examiner note: It clarifies the proposition, proves the mechanism and avoids the sovereignty trap.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 4 mechanisms, 3 correctives and one reform verdict.

Why this earns marks: The answer links cabinet growth to agenda, whip and time control while retaining constitutional counterweights and a degree-based conclusion.

How to improve this answer: For 150 words, keep Article 75(3), agenda control, whip, committee/Question Hour counterweight and one activation reform; avoid repeating the word dominance.

Routed Parliament Prelims demand laboratory

Answer-key provenance: For 2018-2023, official keys are not held locally. For 2024-2025, official Set-A keys are held locally but no option letter is reproduced or inferred here. For 2026, the locally held Set-A keys are provisional and no option letter is reproduced or inferred. Each entry therefore gives the doctrinal solution and elimination logic, not an invented key.

2018-2023 routed demands: 11

Year/Q	Demand	Doctrinal resolution	Provenance/limit
2018 Q1	First Lok Sabha opposition/LoP history	LoP is a statutory office under the 1977 Act; the Act prescribes no ten-percent threshold and leaves recognition to the presiding officer. Distinguish statutory text, recognition practice and largest opposition-party leadership.	Official key unavailable locally; do not invent first-party identity without exact source.
2018 Q20	Committee scrutinising delegated legislation	Committee on Subordinate Legislation examines whether delegated powers are properly exercised.	Not PAC, Estimates or Government Assurances.
2018 Q31	Money Bill definition/procedure	Article 110 “only” test; Lok Sabha origin; President recommendation; Speaker certificate; Rajya Sabha recommendations within 14 days; no joint sitting.	Official key unavailable locally; resolve each statement doctrinally.
2019 Q49	Parliament Disqualification Act/office of profit	Articles 102/103 plus Parliament (Prevention of Disqualification) Act, 1959; President decides a sitting-member question after ECI opinion.	Exemption is office-specific, not a general immunity.
2019 Q69	Committees reviewing independent regulators	No single general “regulators committee”; relevant DRSC scrutinises the regulator with its parent ministry and subject field.	Committee jurisdiction follows ministry/subject allocation.
2020 Q2	Rajya Sabha powers equal to Lok Sabha	Equal on ordinary Bills, constitutional amendments and specified elections; unequal on Money Bills, demands and confidence; RS alone initiates Articles 249/312.	Avoid absolute equal/unequal statements.
2020 Q3	MPLADS inspection/carry-forward	MPLADS is a scheme; funds are non-lapsable and carry forward; utilisation is monitored/inspected under the scheme framework.	No current per-MP rupee amount is quoted without live official verification.
2020 Q20	Sessions, summoning and minimum sittings	President summons under Article 85; gap between sessions cannot exceed six months; no constitutional minimum sitting-day count.	Three named sessions are convention, not constitutional compulsion.
2022 Q15	Exclusive Lok Sabha powers	Money Bill origin/certification route, voting demands and holding confidence key are Lok Sabha domains; distinguish from shared legislative powers.	RS has separate Articles 249/312 powers.

Year/Q	Demand	Doctrinal resolution	Provenance/limit
2022 Q20	Deputy Speaker election and powers	House elects under Article 93; when presiding, Deputy has Speaker's powers and casting vote; answerable to House, not Speaker; no constitutional deadline.	Do not assume a current vacancy without verification.
2023 Q37	Finance Bill and Money Bill procedure	Money Bill is the narrow Article 110 subset. Financial Bill-I starts in LS on recommendation but RS has full power; Financial Bill-II may start in either House and recommendation is needed before consideration.	"All Money Bills are Financial Bills, not vice versa."

2024-2025 routed demands: 7

Year/Q	Demand	Doctrinal resolution	Provenance/limit
2024 Q68	Article 109/Money Bill and Rajya Sabha	RS cannot reject/amend; it recommends within 14 days; LS may reject recommendations; no return means deemed passage in LS form.	Official Set-A key exists locally; no option letter recorded here.
2024 Q80	Lok Sabha Ethics Committee	Examines unethical conduct of members; distinct from Privileges Committee, which addresses privilege/contempt.	Do not merge ethical misconduct and institutional privilege.
2024 Q81	Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam	106th Amendment: Arts 330A/332A/334A; enacted 2023, commenced 16 Apr 2026, reservation not operational pending publication -> delimitation sequence.	Official key exists; current status updated beyond exam date. No 2041 calculation.
2024 Q93	Speaker during removal resolution	Article 96: Speaker does not preside; may speak and vote in first instance, but no casting vote in that proceeding.	Removal requires effective majority and 14 days' notice.
2024 Q94	Bill lapse on dissolution	Lapses if pending in LS or passed LS/pending RS; survives if pending only in RS, awaiting assent, returned, or joint sitting notified.	Apply status, not a blanket rule.
2024 Q95	Prorogation/dissolution	Both are President's acts under Article 85; prorogation ends session and Bills survive; dissolution ends LS life; adjournment is chair's act.	RS is never dissolved.
2025 Q87	Speaker after dissolution/party resignation	Speaker continues until immediately before new House first sitting; Indian Speaker need not resign party membership.	Official Set-A key exists; no option letter recorded here.

2026 routed demands: 2

Year/Q	Demand	Doctrinal resolution	Provenance/limit
2026 Q58	Starred, unstarred and supplementary questions	Starred: oral and supplementary allowed; unstarred: written and no supplementaries; supplementary is follow-up to oral answer; short-notice is a distinct urgent oral category.	Local Set-A key is provisional; no option letter recorded or inferred.
2026 Q59	Welfare of SCs/STs Committee	30 members = 20 LS + 10 RS; one-year term; chair appointed by Speaker; ministers barred; examines NCSC/NCST reports and Article 335 representation.	Parliamentary committee, not the constitutional Commissions. Provisional-key caution applies.

Original solved Mains practice

M1. Explain how the constitutional design of parliamentary sessions both enables and limits executive accountability. (10 marks, 150 words)

Demand decoding: “Explain how” requires a mechanism, not merely definitions. Cover summoning rule, devices and the weak sitting-day floor.

Model solution

Claim: Session design keeps the executive periodically answerable but leaves the intensity of accountability to political control of the calendar.

Named evidence: **Article 85** prevents more than six months between sessions, ensuring at least two annual opportunities for scrutiny. Within sittings, starred questions, supplementaries, Zero Hour, Calling Attention and motions demand explanation; **Article 75(3)** allows Lok Sabha to test confidence.

Analysis: Periodic summoning prevents indefinite executive rule without Parliament, while oral questions and motions convert presence into public responsibility.

Qualification: The Constitution fixes no minimum sitting days and does not mandate three named sessions. Executive influence over summoning, disruption and loss of Question Hour may satisfy Article 85 while weakening real scrutiny.

Verdict: The design guarantees recurrence, not adequacy. A predictable calendar and protected accountability time would convert the six-month floor into effective control.

Examiner comment: Strong because Article 85 is linked to actual devices and its design limitation, rather than treated as a calendar fact.

Why this earns marks: Direct thesis; two Articles; mechanism; qualification; feasible reform within 150-word scale.

How to improve this answer: If space is tight, retain Article 85, two live accountability devices and the no-minimum-sitting-days qualification; state the reform as protected scrutiny time.

M2. Legislative privilege is a functional immunity, not a personal impunity. Discuss with reference to *Sita Soren*. (10 marks, 150 words)

Demand decoding: Define function, apply the case and preserve the surviving immunity.

Model solution

Claim: Article 105 protects fearless legislative functioning, not private criminal bargains.

Named evidence: It immunises proceedings for speech and vote in Parliament and protects authorised parliamentary publication. Yet in ***Sita Soren v. Union of India (2024)*** a unanimous seven-judge Bench overruled *P.V. Narasimha Rao* and held that accepting a bribe for a speech or vote attracts no Article 105/194 immunity; bribery is complete on acceptance.

Analysis: The functional-nexus test explains the distinction: debate and voting require autonomy from external litigation, whereas a bribe subverts rather than enables that function.

Qualification: The judgment did not expose bona fide speeches or votes to ordinary suits. Nor does judicial review authorise courts to manage routine House procedure.

Verdict: Privilege remains a shield for institutional independence, but *Sita Soren* correctly denies its conversion into a personal criminal safe harbour.

Examiner comment: Uses exact case proposition and avoids the frequent overstatement that all speech immunity has disappeared.

Why this earns marks: Definition, Article, overruled precedent, functional analysis and precise qualification.

How to improve this answer: Keep the functional-nexus test, the overruled precedent and the acceptance-completes-bribery rule; do not imply that ordinary speech immunity disappeared.

M3. The Money Bill procedure is necessary for popular control of finance but vulnerable to bicameral bypass. Critically examine. (15 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: "Critically examine" requires the rationale, misuse risk, case law and a bounded verdict.

Model solution

Claim: Articles 109-110 legitimately privilege the directly elected Lok Sabha in narrowly fiscal legislation, but overbroad certification can convert financial primacy into general legislative supremacy.

Named evidence: A Money Bill must contain **only** Article 110(1)(a)-(g) matters and incidental provisions. It begins in Lok Sabha on presidential recommendation; Rajya Sabha may only recommend within fourteen days, and no joint sitting exists. The Speaker certifies it, with Article 110 calling the decision final.

Analysis: This design protects supply and taxation from Upper-House obstruction and aligns financial responsibility with the House that can dismiss the ministry. However, classification also removes Rajya Sabha's amendment veto. Adding substantial non-fiscal provisions therefore harms bicameralism and federal revision.

Judicial evidence: *Puttaswamy (Aadhaar)*, 2018 upheld the Aadhaar route by 4:1; *Rojer Mathew* (2019) doubted the reasoning and referred the larger question to seven judges.

Qualification: Textual finality is not ordinary merits appeal, yet narrow constitutional review for illegality/misuse remains. As of 28 August 2026 no visible final larger-Bench resolution was located.

Verdict: Popular financial control requires the special procedure, but constitutional fidelity requires strict enforcement of "only", reasoned certification and narrow review.

Examiner comment: Balances democratic rationale and federal cost, uses both leading cases and preserves current-status caution.

Why this earns marks: Article -> mechanism -> consequence -> cases -> qualification -> reform verdict.

How to improve this answer: Use a two-column rationale-versus-bypass frame; quote Article 110 only, preserve the pending-status date and avoid presenting review as a merits appeal.

M4. Parliament's power of the purse is exercised through a chain, not a single budget vote. Analyse. (15 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: Build the complete authorisation-to-audit cycle and identify weak links.

Model solution

Claim: Financial control is a sequence of disclosure, deliberation, authorisation, expenditure and audit rather than one annual approval.

Named evidence and analysis: **Article 112** requires the Annual Financial Statement and distinguishes charged from voted expenditure. Under **Article 113**, Lok Sabha alone votes demands for grants, using Policy, Economy and Token Cut Motions. DRSCs examine ministry demands before voting, though the **guillotine** may pass undiscussed demands. **Article 114** then requires an Appropriation Act before withdrawal from the Consolidated Fund, while the Finance Bill enacts taxation. **Articles 115-116** provide supplementary, additional, excess grants, vote on account, vote of credit and exceptional grants. After spending, the **CAG** audits and the **PAC** examines reports; excess expenditure is regularised only after this post-facto scrutiny.

Qualification: Rajya Sabha discusses but does not vote demands. Charged expenditure is discussed but not voted. Public Account withdrawal is outside appropriation. Majority discipline makes cut-motion success rare, and PAC review is retrospective.

Verdict: The chain is constitutionally comprehensive but only as strong as DRSC time, grant debate and audit follow-up. Protecting these stages matters more than ritual budget passage.

Examiner comment: The answer maps the entire cycle and differentiates charged expenditure, Public Account and Rajya Sabha's role.

Why this earns marks: Six named constitutional/institutional units linked analytically rather than listed.

How to improve this answer: Draw the authorisation-to-audit chain first, then add charged expenditure and Public Account as the two highest-value distinctions; omit minor grant taxonomy if necessary.

M5. Delimitation after the population freeze is simultaneously a democratic-equality and a federal-fairness problem. Examine with reference to the women's reservation trigger. (15 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: Examine both normative claims, then integrate Article 334A and current controls.

Model solution

Claim: Restoring population-proportional representation answers malapportionment but may penalise States that reduced fertility, making delimitation a federal bargain rather than a cartographic exercise.

Named evidence: Article 81(2)(a) links State seats to population. The **42nd Amendment** froze allocation on 1971 figures; the **84th Amendment** extended readjustment until publication of the first post-2026 census figures; the **87th** enabled 2001-based boundary readjustment. Because Rajya Sabha is population-weighted rather than equal-per-State, low-growth States lack a US-Senate-type counterweight.

Women's-reservation link: The **106th Amendment** inserted Articles 330A, 332A and 334A. It commenced on **16 April 2026**, but Article 334A requires publication of relevant first post-commencement census figures and delimitation before reservation operates. Census 2027 is the trigger census, yet publication and delimitation dates are unknown.

Counterpoint: Permanent under-representation of populous citizens is itself a democratic deficit; the freeze cannot substitute forever for representation.

Qualification: The defeated 131st Amendment Bill's 850 ceiling and 2011 basis are not law. No State or women's-seat projection is valid.

Verdict: Reform must reconcile vote equality with demographic-performance fairness, possibly through negotiated House design, without forecasting an outcome the Constitution has not yet produced.

Examiner comment: Integrates static freeze law, federal theory and the exact commenced-but-not-operational sequence.

Why this earns marks: Balanced normative analysis with Articles, amendments, current trigger and explicit risk controls.

How to improve this answer: Separate democratic equality, federal fairness and Article 334A into three paragraphs; never turn the defeated 850-seat proposal or an unknown publication date into law.

M6. "Parliament is strong in constitutional instruments but weak in their political use." Critically examine and propose reforms. (20 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: Test both halves, cover the full accountability architecture and rank reforms.

Model solution

Claim: Parliament retains formidable powers over law, supply and executive survival, yet majority discipline and scarcity of scrutiny time often convert control into formal ratification.

Strength in instruments: Article 75(3) permits no-confidence removal; questions, motions and debates force explanation. Articles 112-114 require financial disclosure, grant voting and appropriation. Ordinary Bills need bicameral consent; DRSCs provide detailed ministry scrutiny; PAC-CAG review closes the audit loop. Rajya Sabha adds continuity and Articles 249/312.

Weakness in use: The Tenth Schedule discourages independent voting; government controls most business; disruption reduces Question Hour; the guillotine passes demands without debate; Bill referral is optional; ordinances and contested Money Bill routing compress scrutiny. Speaker-linked defection and certification powers create neutrality concerns.

Counter-evidence: Committee consensus, opposition-led PAC work, judicial review and public debate can alter policy even when the government wins every vote. Weakness varies with coalition arithmetic and institutional leadership.

Reform: create a predictable sitting calendar; protect questions and opposition time; make committee referral the default with reasoned urgency exceptions; strengthen research/action-taken review; narrow the whip to confidence/core supply; require timely, reasoned presiding-officer decisions.

Verdict: The constitutional hardware remains sound; political incentives and procedural time are the failing software. Reform should activate existing accountability before inventing new devices.

Examiner comment: Covers instruments, causal limits, counterevidence and a prioritised reform package within the directive.

Why this earns marks: Eight named evidence units and a memorable but qualified hardware/software verdict.

How to improve this answer: Rank reforms by the diagnosed cause: time, information, referral and whip. In a shorter answer retain four instruments, four constraints and three matched remedies.

M7. Evaluate whether Rajya Sabha and parliamentary committees together can compensate for executive dominance of Lok Sabha. (20 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: Evaluate two institutions jointly, specify what they can and cannot compensate for, and give a degree-based judgment.

Model solution

Claim: Rajya Sabha and committees can improve revision, information and financial audit, but cannot fully neutralise a disciplined executive majority controlling confidence, supply and House time.

Rajya Sabha contribution: It is equal on ordinary and constitutional amendment Bills, permanent, committee-integrated and capable of federal debate. **Articles 249 and 312** give it exclusive federal initiative. A government lacking an Upper-House majority must negotiate on non-Money legislation.

Committee contribution: The **24 DRSCs (21 LS + 10 RS each)** scrutinise demands, referred Bills and reports; **PAC (15+7)** connects CAG audit to parliamentary accountability; Estimates and CoPU add prospective and undertaking-specific scrutiny. Smaller forums encourage expertise and cross-party consensus.

Limits: Article 109 reduces Rajya Sabha to recommendations on Money Bills; it cannot vote demands or remove the ministry under Article 75(3). Joint-sitting numbers favour Lok Sabha. Committee reports are advisory, Bill referral varies and the executive can control information and follow-up. Overbroad Money Bill use may bypass both Upper-House veto and ordinary committee pressure.

Qualification: Influence is not measured only by government defeat; reports, delay, amendment and public reasons can improve law.

Verdict: Together they are strong compensating correctives but not a counter-government. Strict Article 110 classification, default referral, research capacity and protected scrutiny time are needed for meaningful balance.

Examiner comment: Integrates bicameral and committee mechanisms and defines compensation by scrutiny quality rather than vote defeat alone.

Why this earns marks: Joint institutional evaluation, exact committee evidence, structural limits and reform-linked verdict.

How to improve this answer: Evaluate compensation by revision, information and audit rather than government defeat; preserve Money Bill, confidence and non-binding-report limits in the final paragraph.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

A1. Constitutional supremacy versus parliamentary supremacy

Visual 40 - Three levels of authority

CONSTITUTIONAL SUPREMACY

written text + federal distribution + rights + judicial review + basic structure

PARLIAMENTARY CENTRALITY

law, supply, representation, accountability, amendment

EXECUTIVE AGENDA DOMINANCE

government controls most Bills, time and majority management

- [ANALYSIS] “Parliamentary supremacy” in Indian GS-II questions usually means effective deliberative and control capacity, not unlimited legal sovereignty.
- [FACT] Parliament cannot enact ordinary law beyond constitutional competence, and Article 368 itself is limited by the basic-structure doctrine.
- [ANALYSIS] Cabinet dominance can marginalise Parliament without transferring constitutional sovereignty to the Cabinet.

A2. Money Bill certification and the unresolved larger-Bench issue

- [FACT] In *K.S. Puttaswamy (Aadhaar), 2018*, a 4:1 majority upheld the Aadhaar Act's Money Bill route; Chandrachud J dissented.
- [FACT] In *Rojer Mathew v. South Indian Bank* (2019), the Court doubted the earlier Article 110 reasoning and referred the issue to a larger seven-judge Bench.
- [CURRENT] As of 28 August 2026, no visible final decision resolving that larger-Bench issue was located on the official Supreme Court judgment portals.
- [LIMIT] The safe formulation is: **Article 110 calls the Speaker's decision final, but constitutional courts retain narrow review for illegality or constitutional misuse; the larger doctrinal issue remains without a visible final resolution.**

Visual 41 - Judicial-review boundary

Speaker's Article 110 certificate: textually final

not ordinary merits appeal

narrow constitutional review for illegality/misuse

larger doctrinal issue referred in *Rojer Mathew*

no visible final ruling by 28 Aug 2026

A3. Procedure refinements that separate strong answers

- [FACT] A private member may introduce an ordinary Bill; “government Bill” describes sponsor, not a separate constitutional class.
- [FACT] A Financial Bill-I is not a Money Bill: it starts only in Lok Sabha on recommendation, but Rajya Sabha retains full amending/rejecting power and joint sitting is possible.
- [FACT] A Financial Bill-II may originate in either House; recommendation is needed before consideration because expenditure from the Consolidated Fund is involved.
- [FACT] A constitutional amendment deadlock is fatal to the Bill; neither joint sitting nor a suspensive presidential return exists.
- [FACT] A joint sitting already notified survives dissolution, showing that presidential notification changes the lapse position.
- [ANALYSIS] Procedure questions reward classification before narration: identify Bill type first, then origin, recommendation, Rajya Sabha power, deadlock route and assent.

A4. Committees as the realistic deliberative centre

- [ANALYSIS] Televised floors reward party signalling; smaller committees lower visibility costs, allow evidence-taking and make cross-party bargaining easier.
- [ANALYSIS] Their value comes from continuity, specialisation and information, not from power to bind the government.
- [LIMIT] “Mini-Parliaments” is an analytical label. Committees cannot replace plenary passage, confidence or final appropriation.
- [ANALYSIS] The strongest reform is default referral with a public, reasoned urgency exception, backed by research capacity and action-taken tracking.

A5. Concise source and current-control note

- Authoritative Core: Polity/basic/Parliament.md.
- Optional procedure source: Polity/advanced/17_Parliament.md; its stale statement that no 106th Amendment commencement notification was located has been superseded and is not repeated.
- Cross-links used: Polity 11, Polity 16, Anti-Defection, Election Commission, Amendment and Basic Structure, President and Vice-President.
- Official parliamentary control: <https://sansad.in/> and Digital Sansad debates/Bills/committee records.
- Official 7th Session overview: <https://static.pib.gov.in/WriteReadData/specificdocs/documents/2026/apr/doc2026418851201.pdf>.
- Official Census control: <https://censusindia.gov.in/>.
- [LIMIT] Session labels, office holders, committee chairs, committee referrals, live Bill status and litigation status must be rechecked before future present-tense use.
- [LIMIT] No current MPLADS amount is quoted. The stable routed propositions are that MPLADS is a scheme, funds are non-lapsable and utilisation is monitored/inspected through the scheme framework.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Article 79 identity card

Parliament = President + Rajya Sabha + Lok Sabha

President: integral, not a member

India: constitutional supremacy, not British legal parliamentary sovereignty

- [FACT] President summons, prorogues, addresses and assents.
- [ANALYSIS] Lok Sabha = popular/financial-confidence chamber; Rajya Sabha = permanent/federal-revising chamber.
- **Trap:** Never define Parliament as the two Houses alone.

Two Houses: composition, election and term

Recall	Rajya Sabha	Lok Sabha
Ceiling	250	550
Core current strength	245 sanctioned	543 elected
Election	MLAs; PR-STV; open ballot	Direct; FPTP
Nomination	12	None
Age	30	25
Term	Member: 6 years; one-third every 2 years	House: normally 5 years
Dissolution	Never	Yes

- [FACT] 104th Amendment ended Anglo-Indian nomination to Lok Sabha.

- [FACT] 2003 Rajya Sabha domicile/open-ballot changes were statutory; *Kuldip Nayar* upheld them.
- **Trap:** Rajya Sabha is population-weighted, not equal-per-State.

Delimitation and freeze chronology

42nd Amdt, 1976 -> freeze on 1971 basis

84th Amdt, 2001 -> defer until relevant first post-2026 census figures are published

87th Amdt, 2003 -> 2001 figures for boundary readjustment

Article 82 -> readjustment authority fixed by Parliament

Article 329(a) -> delimitation law/allotment insulated from court challenge

- [FACT] Four all-India Delimitation Commissions: 1952, 1962, 1972, 2002 Acts.
- [LIMIT] Jammu and Kashmir post-2019 was a distinct statutory exercise.
- [LIMIT] No automatic unfreezing on 1 January 2026 and no lawful State-wise projection.

Membership and disqualification quick card

- **Article 84:** citizenship; oath; 30 RS/25 LS; statutory qualifications.
- **Article 102:** office of profit; court-declared unsound mind; undischarged insolvent; foreign citizenship/allegiance; parliamentary-law disqualification; Tenth Schedule.
- **Article 103:** President decides sitting-member Article 102(1) question after ECI opinion.
- **RPA 1951:** conviction/corrupt practice/dismissal/government contract/government-company office/expense-account grounds.
- **Lily Thomas (2013):** no sitting-member section 8(4) shield; stay conviction, not merely sentence.
- **Trap:** Election petition in High Court and Article 103 reference are distinct routes.

Office of profit and Leader of Opposition

- [FACT] Office-of-profit purpose: prevent executive patronage from compromising legislative independence.
- [FACT] Tests include appointment/removal, remuneration, governmental control and functions.
- [FACT] Parliament (Prevention of Disqualification) Act, 1959 exempts listed offices.
- [FACT] LoP is statutory under the 1977 Act; the Act itself contains no ten-percent threshold.
- [LIMIT] Recognition practice and statutory text must not be conflated.
- [LIMIT] Largest opposition leader and formally recognised LoP may differ.
- **PYQ trap:** Do not invent the first Lok Sabha opposition party without exact verified source.

Session and sitting vocabulary

Term	Controller	Effect
Summoning	President	Calls House/session
Adjournment	Presiding officer	Pauses sitting
Adjournment sine die	Presiding officer	Ends sitting without next date
Prorogation	President	Ends session; Bills survive
Dissolution	President	Ends Lok Sabha life; selective Bill lapse

- **Article 85:** no more than six months between sessions.
- **Article 100(3):** quorum one-tenth; Core recall 55 LS/25 RS.
- **Trap:** No constitutional minimum sitting days; Budget/Monsoon/Winter are conventions.
- [CURRENT] 8th Session of 18th Lok Sabha adjourned sine die 13 August 2026.

Questions and motions memory grid

Starred = oral + supplementaries

Unstarred = written + no supplementaries

Short-notice = urgent, shorter notice, oral

Zero Hour = Indian innovation; not in Rules

Information -> discussion -> censure -> finance -> confidence

- Calling Attention: urgent ministerial statement.
- Half-an-Hour: clarify an earlier answer.
- Short-Duration: discussion without formal vote.
- Adjournment Motion: urgent definite matter, censure, Lok Sabha, 50.
- No-Confidence: Lok Sabha, 50 for admission, no reasons necessary.
- **Article 75(3)**: collective responsibility only to Lok Sabha.

Presiding-officer card

- **Speaker**: Articles 93-97; House-elected; resignation to Deputy; removal by effective majority after 14 days.
- **Continuity**: remains after dissolution until immediately before new House first sitting.
- **Article 96**: does not preside over own removal; may vote first instance, no casting vote.
- **Powers**: rules/order; Article 110 certificate; Article 108 joint sitting; Article 100 casting vote; Tenth Schedule.
- **Deputy Speaker**: independently House-elected; full powers when presiding; no constitutional numerical deadline.
- [CURRENT]/[LIMIT] 17th Lok Sabha had no Deputy Speaker; do not assume current 18th Lok Sabha vacancy.
- **Chairman RS**: Vice-President ex officio, not RS member; Deputy Chairman elected by RS.

Privilege and bribery firewall

- **Article 105**: speech/vote immunity and parliamentary publication protection.
- **Breach of privilege**: violation of a specific privilege.
- **Contempt**: wider obstruction of House functioning.
- **Raja Ram Pal (2007)**: legislative privilege subject to limited review for illegality.
- **Sita Soren (2024)**: seven judges, unanimous; *P.V. Narasimha Rao* overruled; no bribery immunity; offence complete on acceptance.
- **Trap**: *Sita Soren* did not abolish bona fide speech/vote privilege.

Bill procedure compact spine

Introduction -> general discussion -> committee/consideration ->

third reading -> second House -> President

- Ordinary Bill: either House; both agree; Article 111 return once possible.
- Private Member's Bill: sponsor category, not separate constitutional Bill class.
- Committee referral: valuable but not constitutionally automatic.

Bill-class firewall

Class	Origin	Rajya Sabha	Joint sitting
Ordinary	Either House	Equal	Yes
Money, Arts 109-110	LS only	14-day recommendations	No
Financial-I, Art 117(1)	LS only	Full	Yes
Financial-II, Art 117(3)	Either House	Full	Yes
Amendment, Art 368	Either House	Equal/separate passage	No

- **Money Bill**: only Article 110 matters + incidental; Speaker certificate.

- **Financial-I:** Article 110 matters plus other matters.
- **Financial-II:** expenditure from Consolidated Fund, but not Article 110 class.
- **Amendment:** total-membership majority + two-thirds present/voting; some also half-State ratification; President must assent.

Money Bill current doctrine

- **Puttaswamy (2018):** Aadhaar route upheld 4:1; dissent challenged it.
- **Rojer Mathew (2019):** larger seven-judge reference.
- [CURRENT] No visible final larger-Bench decision located by 16 August 2026.
- [LIMIT] Safe phrase: Article 110 certificate is textually final but subject to narrow constitutional review for illegality/misuse.

Joint sitting and lapse rules

- **Article 108:** rejection/final disagreement/six-month delay for eligible Bills.
- **Presiding officer:** Lok Sabha Speaker.
- **Only three:** Dowry 1961; Banking Service 1978; POTA 2002.
- **No joint sitting:** Money Bill or constitutional amendment.

LAPSES: pending LS | passed LS, pending RS
 SURVIVES: pending RS only | awaiting assent | returned by President |
 joint sitting already notified

Budget and grant chain

Art 112 AFS -> general discussion -> DRSC ->
 Art 113 demands/cuts/guillotine ->
 Art 114 Appropriation -> Finance Bill ->
 CAG -> PAC -> excess-grant regularisation

- Charged: discussed, not voted.
- Demands: Lok Sabha only; President recommendation.
- Policy Cut: Re 1; Economy Cut: specified amount; Token Cut: Rs 100.
- Article 115: supplementary/additional/excess.
- Article 116: vote on account/vote of credit/exceptional grant.
- **Trap:** supplementary = in-year insufficiency; excess = post-facto overspending.

Constitutional funds

- **Consolidated Fund, Art 266(1):** appropriation required.
- **Public Account, Art 266(2):** appropriation not required.
- **Contingency Fund, Art 267:** unforeseen advance; later recouped.
- **Trap:** Not every public-money withdrawal uses identical procedure.

Executive accountability stack

Questions -> debates/motions -> legislation -> budget ->
 DRSC scrutiny -> CAG/PAC audit -> no-confidence -> elections

- [ANALYSIS] Strong instruments: law, supply, information and survival.
- [ANALYSIS] Weak use: whip, majority, executive agenda, disruption, guillotine, limited referral and acceleration routes.
- **Verdict:** textually strong, behaviourally uneven.

Committee numbers that must not be swapped

Committee	Composition	Key function
PAC	22 = 15+7	CAG/post-expenditure
Estimates	30 LS only	Economy/efficiency in estimates
CoPU	22 = 15+7	Public undertakings
DRSC	31 = 21+10	Ministry demands/Bills/reports
Welfare SC/ST	30 = 20+10	NCSC/NCST reports; Article 335

- DRSC chronology: **17 in 1993 -> 24 from 2004.**
- DRSC service: **16 LS Secretariat + 8 RS Secretariat.**
- Ministers barred in financial trio, DRSCs and Welfare SC/ST as controlled by Core.
- Subordinate Legislation, not PAC, scrutinises delegated legislation.
- Ethics ≠ Privileges.
- Consultative Committee ≠ parliamentary committee.

Rajya Sabha graded-power card

- **Equal:** ordinary Bills; Article 368 amendments; major electoral participation.
- **Weaker:** Money Bills; demands for grants; confidence.
- **Numerically weaker:** joint sitting.
- **Exclusive Core pair:** Article 249 and Article 312.
- **Continuity:** permanent House.
- **Verdict:** supporting on money/confidence, co-equal on law/amendment, distinctive on federation.

Anti-defection impact

- **52nd Amendment, 1985:** Tenth Schedule.
- **91st Amendment, 2003:** split deleted; merger only at two-thirds; office/cap reforms.
- Grounds: voluntarily giving up; whip defiance not permitted/condoned within 15 days.
- Independent joins party -> disqualified.
- Nominated joins after six months -> disqualified.
- **Kihoto Hollohan:** Speaker tribunal, reviewable.
- **Keisham Meghachandra:** about three-month norm suggested; independent tribunal proposed.
- [ANALYSIS] Stability gain <-> deliberative autonomy loss.

IPG-IPU-CPA recall

IPG: Indian parliamentary association, 1949
IPG -> India's National Group in IPU
IPG -> main India Branch in CPA
IPU: global national-parliament organisation
CPA: Commonwealth parliamentary network

- Speaker = ex-officio IPG President.
- Deputy Speaker + RS Deputy Chairman = ex-officio Vice-Presidents.
- **Trap:** IPG is not MEA; IPU is not inter-governmental.

Parliamentary decline and reform spine

Diagnosis

1. Executive controls drafting and most time.
2. Whip reduces member independence.
3. Disruption and few sittings reduce questioning.
4. Guillotine passes unexamined grants.
5. Optional committee referral thins legal scrutiny.
6. Ordinance/contested Money Bill routes compress bicameralism.

Counterweights

1. No-confidence and supply.
2. Questions and motions.
3. Rajya Sabha revision.
4. DRSC and PAC-CAG.
5. Judicial review.
6. Elections/public debate.

Priority reforms

1. Predictable calendar and protected scrutiny time.
2. Default Bill referral with reasoned urgency exceptions.
3. Research staff and action-taken monitoring.
4. Narrower whip for confidence/core finance.
5. Timely, reasoned presiding-officer decisions.
6. Strict Article 110 “only” test.

Women's reservation three-register card

Register	Status on 28 Aug 2026
Enacted/incorporated	Yes; assented September 2023; Arts 330A/332A/334A
Commenced	Yes; 16 April 2026
Operational reservation	No

commencement -> first post-commencement census ->
publication of relevant figures -> delimitation for this purpose ->
reservation takes effect

- One-third in LS, State Assemblies and Delhi Assembly, including within SC/ST seats.
- Article 334A(2): continuance as Parliament may by law determine.
- Article 334A(3): rotation after each subsequent delimitation.
- **Trap:** Quote “fifteen years from such commencement”; never calculate 2041.

Census 2027 trigger card

- Houselisting window: 1 April-30 September 2026; State/UT-specific 30-day period.
- Population Enumeration: February 2027 generally; September 2026 snow-bound.
- Reference: 1 March 2027 generally; 1 October 2026 snow-bound.
- First fully digital census; self-enumeration; caste enumeration announced.
- Statutory basis: Census Act 1948 and Rules 1990.
- [LIMIT] Publication date unknown -> delimitation date unknown -> reservation-operation date unknown.

Defeated 2026 Bills card

Introduced 16 Apr:

131st Amendment Bill + Delimitation Bill + UT Laws Amendment Bill

Division 17 Apr:

298 for : 230 against; 528 present/voting

total-membership limb cleared

two-thirds present/voting limb failed

Result:

constitutional amendment defeated; linked Bills did not pass

- Proposed 850 ceiling = 815 States + 35 UTs, **Bill text only**.
- Proposed 2011 Census basis = **Bill proposal only**.
- Existing law: ceiling 550; elected 543; Article 334A unchanged.
- **Trap**: A defeated Bill is not law, precedent or forecast.

PYQ routing map

- **Mains direct**: 2018 committees; 2019 MP decline; 2020 Speaker; 2020 Rajya Sabha; 2021 accountability; 2021 DRSCs; 2023 committee architecture.
- **Cross-owned Mains**: 2024 cabinet growth/parliamentary marginalisation.
- **Prelims 2018-2023**: LoP history; Subordinate Legislation; Money Bill; office of profit; regulator oversight; RS powers; MPLADS; sessions; LS exclusive powers; Deputy Speaker; Finance/Money Bill.
- **Prelims 2024-2025**: Money Bill; Ethics; 106th Amendment; Speaker removal; Bill lapse; prorogation/dissolution; Speaker continuity/party.
- **Prelims 2026**: question types; Welfare SC/ST Committee.
- **Provenance**: 2018-2023 keys unavailable locally; 2024-2025 official keys held but option letters not reproduced; 2026 key provisional.

Universal Mains answer checklist

1. Decode directive and every limb
2. State a direct thesis
3. Use mark-scaled named evidence
4. Explain what each evidence unit proves
5. Add counterpoint/status qualification
6. Give a degree-based verdict

- **10 marks**: 2-3 named evidence units.
- **15 marks**: 4-6 named evidence units.
- **20 marks**: 5-8 named evidence units plus reform/graded judgment where demanded.
- **Non-negotiable pattern**: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

Final rapid-fire traps

1. President is part of Parliament, not a House member.
2. RS ceiling 250; LS ceiling 550; Core strengths 245/543.
3. Anglo-Indian Lok Sabha nomination is abolished.
4. Freeze waits for publication of relevant post-2026 census figures.
5. No constitutional minimum sitting days.
6. Prorogation ends session; dissolution ends Lok Sabha.
7. Starred questions allow supplementaries; unstarred do not.
8. Zero Hour is not in the Rules.
9. Speaker survives dissolution and does not preside over own removal.
10. Official control checked 28 August 2026 dates the Deputy Speaker vacancy from May 2019.
11. *Sita Soren* removes bribery immunity, not bona fide speech immunity.

12. Money Bill contains only Article 110 matters.
13. Financial Bill-I is not subject to 14-day RS restriction.
14. No joint sitting for Money or amendment Bills.
15. Only three historical joint sittings.
16. Charged expenditure is discussed, not voted.
17. Policy Cut = Re 1; Token Cut = Rs 100.
18. Public Account does not need appropriation.
19. PAC 22; Estimates 30 LS-only; CoPU 22.
20. DRSC: 17 in 1993, 24 from 2004, 31 = 21+10.
21. Welfare SC/ST: 30 = 20+10.
22. RS exclusive Core pair: Articles 249 and 312.
23. Tenth Schedule merger threshold: two-thirds.
24. IPG = IPU National Group + CPA main India Branch.
25. 106th Amendment commenced 16 April 2026; reservation not operational.
26. Census enumeration/reference date is not publication date.
27. Never derive a 2041 women's-reservation end date.
28. 131st Amendment/Delimitation/UT package was defeated, not enacted.
29. *Rojer Mathew* larger issue has no visible final resolution as of 28 August 2026.
30. Never quote a current MPLADS rupee amount without official live verification.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

High-yield use: Follow the panels as one topic-specific conceptual atlas: root question, classifications, processes or arguments, comparisons, objections and a final answer-writing spine. This text-native master is separate from both graphical flowchart artifacts.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Article 79 architecture, composition and representation

CORE RULE

Article 79 creates one Parliament from the President and two differently constituted Houses.

OPERATING MECHANISM

President + Lok Sabha + Rajya Sabha combine assent, popular mandate and federal revision.

EXAM LIMIT

President is integral to Parliament but is not a member of either House.

ANSWER LINE

Parliament is strong when constitutional power is converted into informed, time-bound scrutiny.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Membership, disqualification, vacancies and opposition

CORE RULE

Articles 84, 101-103 regulate entry, continuity and disqualification; the 1977 Act governs LoP recognition.

OPERATING MECHANISM

Qualification, vacancy, ECI opinion and presiding-officer recognition keep membership legally controlled.

EXAM LIMIT

The 1977 Act has no ten-percent LoP threshold; do not confuse practice with statutory text.

ANSWER LINE

Parliament is strong when constitutional power is converted into informed, time-bound scrutiny.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Sessions, sittings, quorum and accountability devices

CORE RULE

Article 85 guarantees recurrence, while House rules turn sittings into questioning and debate.

OPERATING MECHANISM

Summoning enables questions and motions, but no constitutional minimum sitting-day floor exists.

EXAM LIMIT

Budget, Monsoon and Winter are conventions, not constitutionally fixed sessions.

ANSWER LINE

Parliament is strong when constitutional power is converted into informed, time-bound scrutiny.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Presiding officers, neutrality and privilege

CORE RULE

Articles 93-97 and 105 protect ordered, independent legislative work within reviewable limits.

OPERATING MECHANISM

Chairs manage procedure and privilege protects function; reasoned review checks constitutional misuse.

EXAM LIMIT

Deputy Speaker vacancy since May 2019 is a dated fact, not a constitutional rule.

ANSWER LINE

Parliament is strong when constitutional power is converted into informed, time-bound scrutiny.

CASE CONTROL

Sita Soren (2024): legislative privilege does not immunise bribery.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Ordinary legislation and the Bill-class firewall

CORE RULE

Bill classification determines origin, recommendation, Upper-House power, deadlock and assent.

OPERATING MECHANISM

Correct classification channels each Bill through the constitutionally assigned legislative route.

EXAM LIMIT

A Financial Bill-I is not a Money Bill; Rajya Sabha retains full legislative power.

ANSWER LINE

Parliament is strong when constitutional power is converted into informed, time-bound scrutiny.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Joint sitting, lapse and ordinance return

CORE RULE

Articles 108, 111 and 123 connect deadlock, assent, dissolution and temporary executive lawmaking.

OPERATING MECHANISM

Joint sitting resolves eligible deadlocks; dissolution selectively lapses Bills; ordinances return to Parliament.

EXAM LIMIT

Money and Constitution Amendment Bills have no joint-sitting route.

ANSWER LINE

Parliament is strong when constitutional power is converted into informed, time-bound scrutiny.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Budget, grants, funds and power of the purse

CORE RULE

Articles 112-116 and 266-267 create an authorisation-to-audit chain for public money.

OPERATING MECHANISM

Disclosure, grant voting, appropriation, expenditure and CAG-PAC audit form one control cycle.

EXAM LIMIT

Charged expenditure is discussed not voted; Public Account withdrawal needs no appropriation.

ANSWER LINE

Parliament is strong when constitutional power is converted into informed, time-bound scrutiny.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Committee architecture and detailed scrutiny

CORE RULE

Financial committees, DRSCs and specialised committees supply evidence-based scrutiny beyond the floor.

OPERATING MECHANISM

Small cross-House forums examine estimates, audit, Bills and ministries before reporting to Parliament.

EXAM LIMIT

PAC, Estimates and CoPU differ in composition, time direction and subject.

ANSWER LINE

Parliament is strong when constitutional power is converted into informed, time-bound scrutiny.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: Rajya Sabha, anti-defection and bicameral balance

CORE RULE

Rajya Sabha has graded powers while the Tenth Schedule trades member autonomy for stability.

OPERATING MECHANISM

Upper-House revision and federal powers check Lok Sabha, while whips shape individual voting.

EXAM LIMIT

Rajya Sabha is unequal on money and confidence, but equal or exclusive elsewhere.

ANSWER LINE

Parliament is strong when constitutional power is converted into informed, time-bound scrutiny.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: 106th Amendment, Census 2027 and delimitation

CORE RULE

Women's reservation is commenced but awaits published census figures and purpose-specific delimitation.

OPERATING MECHANISM

Commencement leads to census publication, then delimitation, before reservation can operate.

EXAM LIMIT

The defeated 850-seat proposal and 2011 basis are not existing law.

ANSWER LINE

Parliament is strong when constitutional power is converted into informed, time-bound scrutiny.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Parliamentary decline, reform and diplomacy

CORE RULE

Executive agenda control, time scarcity and wide whips weaken use of otherwise strong instruments.

OPERATING MECHANISM

Matched reforms improve calendar, referral, research, opposition time and reasoned chair decisions.

EXAM LIMIT

Institutional decline is variable political use, not disappearance of constitutional power.

ANSWER LINE

Parliament is strong when constitutional power is converted into informed, time-bound scrutiny.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: PYQ routes, traps and answer execution

CORE RULE

Exam performance requires classification, named evidence, mechanism, qualification and a graded verdict.

OPERATING MECHANISM

PYQs and rotated MCQs convert constitutional distinctions into repeatable answer and elimination routes.

EXAM LIMIT

Never substitute current-sensitive numbers or proposals for stable constitutional rules.

ANSWER LINE

Parliament is strong when constitutional power is converted into informed, time-bound scrutiny.